

Direct Control Services

**Initial Pricing Proposal
2009/10**



**Delivering efficient and
sustainable network services**

25 May 2009

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Front Cover:

*Parramatta by night, supported by
Integral Energy's Parramatta Field Service Centre.*

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Appendices:

Item No.	Description
A	CONFIDENTIAL – Distribution Use of System Tariffs
B	CONFIDENTIAL – Consideration of LRMC
C	CONFIDENTIAL – Climate Change Fund Recovery Tariffs
D	CONFIDENTIAL – Transmission Use of System Tariffs
E	CONFIDENTIAL – Network Use of System Tariffs
F	Public Lighting (Rates 1 and 2)
G	Public Lighting (Rates 3 and 4)
H	Time of Day and Season Definitions
I	CEG Review – Regulatory Cost of Supply Methodology
J	CEG Review – Long Run Marginal Cost Methodology
K	CONFIDENTIAL – 2007/08 Avoided TUOS

Attachments:

Item No.	Description
1	CONFIDENTIAL – AER Weighted Average Price Cap Compliance Model
2	CONFIDENTIAL – Long Run Marginal Cost Model
3	CONFIDENTIAL – Regulatory Cost of Supply Model

Introduction

Integral Energy is submitting this *initial Pricing Proposal (pricing proposal)* to the Australian Energy Regulator (AER) in accordance with the requirements of the National Electricity Rules (the *Rules*), particularly clause 11.15.2 of the Rules and Appendix 1 of Chapter 11, an amended form of Chapter 6 of the Rules applicable to the NSW and ACT distribution businesses, for the purposes of the 2009-2014 regulatory control period (the *Transitional Rules*).

1.1 National Electricity Rules

In accordance with clause 6.1.1 of the *Transitional Rules*, the AER is responsible for the regulation of distribution services provided by means of, or in connection with, distribution systems that form part of the national grid.

1.1.1 Classification of distribution services

In accordance with clause 6.2.3A of the *Transitional Rules*, Distribution services to be provided by the Distribution Network Service Provider (DNSP) are divided into the following three classes:

1. Direct control services;
2. Negotiated distribution services;
3. Unregulated distribution services.

Direct control services are further divided into the following two subclasses:

1. Standard control services; and
2. Alternative control services.

This pricing proposal is relevant to those services provided by Integral Energy that are classified as direct control services.

1.2 Scope of Integral Energy's pricing proposal

In meeting the requirements of Part I of the *Transitional Rules*, and in particular clause 6.18.2(a)(1), Integral Energy's *pricing proposal* sets out the proposed prices required to fund the capital and operating investment programs approved by the Australian Energy Regulator (AER) in the *2009 determination* to ensure a safe and reliable network over the *2009 regulatory control period*.

This *pricing proposal* is submitted in accordance with, and complies with, the requirements of:

1. The National Electricity Law;
2. The National Electricity Rules including the *Transitional Rules*;
3. The AER's 2009-10 to 2013-14 New South Wales distribution determination (*2009 distribution determination*); and
4. The AER's Final Decision on control mechanisms for direct control services for the ACT and NSW 2009 distribution determination.

1.3 Structure of Integral Energy's *pricing proposal*

Integral Energy's *pricing proposal* is structured as follows:

Table 1.1 – Structure of Integral Energy's *pricing proposal*

Chapter	Title	Purpose
2	Regulatory Requirements	Summarises the regulatory requirements as they relate to Integral Energy's <i>pricing proposal</i> , and includes the relevant requirements of the <i>Rules</i> and the AER's <i>2009 determination</i>
3	Business Characteristics	Summarises the characteristics of Integral Energy's network that provide the context for Integral Energy's network tariff strategy.
4	Tariff Classes	Defines the tariff classes into which Integral Energy's customers for direct control services are divided.
5	Network Tariff Strategy	Outlines Integral Energy's Network Tariff Strategy.
6	Network Use of System Tariffs	Describes the nature and extent of the change in Integral Energy's NUOS tariffs between 2008/09 and 2009/10.
7	Customer Impacts	Outlines the expected customer impacts of Integral Energy's <i>pricing proposal</i> .
8	Compliance with Regulatory Requirements	Demonstrates that Integral Energy's <i>pricing proposal</i> complies the regulatory requirements as they relate to Integral Energy's initial <i>pricing proposal</i> .
9	Climate Change Fund	Sets out the amount that Integral Energy must recover from its Climate Change Fund Recovery tariffs.
10	Transmission Cost Recovery Tariffs	Sets out Integral Energy's Transmission cost recovery tariff setting methodology and demonstrates adjustments made to the tariffs resulting from the over recovery of these charges in 2008/09.
11	Customer Reassignment	Sets out the number of customers impacted by and reasons for Integral Energy's 2009/10 tariff

		reassignment strategy
12	Alternate Control Services – Public Lighting Tariffs	Sets out Integral Energy’s Alternate Control Service – Public Lighting Tariffs in accordance with the <i>2009 distribution determination</i> .
Appendices		Separately provided

1.4 Claim for confidentiality

The *Transitional Rules* allow for Integral Energy to provide an indication of the parts of the *pricing proposal* Integral Energy claims to be confidential and wants suppressed from publication on the grounds that the information is confidential. Integral Energy claims confidentiality over the following appendices and attachments and requests that the AER does not disclose the information contained in these appendices and attachments to any person outside of the AER:

Appendices

- Confidential Appendix A – Distribution Use of System Tariffs
- Confidential Appendix B – Consideration of LRMC
- Confidential Appendix C – Climate Change Fund Recovery Tariffs
- Confidential Appendix D – Transmission Cost Recovery Tariffs
- Confidential Appendix E – Network Use of System Tariffs
- Confidential Appendix K – 2007/08 Avoided TUOS

Attachments

- Confidential Attachment 1 - AER Weighted Average Price Cap (WAPC) Compliance Model
- Confidential Attachment 2 – Long Run Marginal Cost Model
- Confidential Attachment 3 – Regulatory Cost of Supply Model

Regulatory Requirements

This Chapter summarises the regulatory requirements as they relate to Integral Energy's initial *pricing proposal*, and includes the relevant requirements of the *Rules* and the AER's 2009 *distribution determination*.

2.1 Requirements of the *Rules*

2.1.1 Required elements of a pricing proposal

In accordance with clause 6.18.2 of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy's *pricing proposal* must include the elements summarised below:

6.18.2 Pricing proposals

(b) A pricing proposal must:

- (1) set out the tariff classes that are to apply for the relevant regulatory year; and
- (2) set out the proposed tariffs for each tariff class; and
- (3) set out, for each proposed tariff, the charging parameters and the elements of service to which each charging parameter relates; and
- (4) set out, for each tariff class related to standard control services, the expected weighted average revenue for the relevant regulatory year and also for the current regulatory year; and
- (5) set out the nature of any variation or adjustment to the tariff that could occur during the course of the regulatory year and the basis on which it could occur; and
- (5A) in the case of a NSW Distribution Network Service Provider – set out the amount paid, or required by an order under the *Energy and Utilities Administration Act 1987* of New South Wales to be paid, by the provider to the Climate Change Fund in or in respect of the relevant regulatory year and reflect that amount in the expected revenue for the relevant regulatory year; and
- (6) set out how charges incurred by the Distribution Network Service

Provider for transmission use of system services are to be passed on to customers and any adjustments to tariffs resulting from over or under recovery of those charges in the previous regulatory year; and

(7) demonstrate compliance with the Rules and any applicable distribution determination; and

(8) describe the nature and extent of change from the previous regulatory year and demonstrate that the changes comply with the Rules and any applicable distribution determination.

(c) The AER must on receipt of a pricing proposal from a Distribution Network Service Provider publish the proposal.

Integral Energy has prepared its *pricing proposal* in accordance with the requirements of the *Transitional Rules*, as summarised above.

In accordance with clause 6.18.2 of the *Transitional Rules* Integral Energy must submit to the AER as soon as practicable and in any case within 15 business days after publication of the distribution determination, a pricing proposal for the first year of the *2009 regulatory control period* (the *initial pricing proposal*).

In addition, Integral Energy must submit to the AER at least two months before the start of the second and each subsequent year of the *2009 regulatory control period*, a further pricing proposal (annual pricing proposal) for the relevant year.

2.1.2 Tariff Classes

In accordance with clause 6.18.3 of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy must satisfy the following criteria with respect to tariff classes:

6.18.3 Tariff classes

(a) A pricing proposal must define the tariff classes into which customers for direct control services are divided.

(b) Each customer for direct control services must be a member of 1 or more tariff classes.

(c) Separate tariff classes must be constituted for customers to whom standard control services are supplied and customers to whom alternative control services are supplied (but a customer for both standard control services and alternative control services may be a member of 2 or more tariff classes).

(d) A tariff class must be constituted with regard to:

(1) the need to group customers together on an economically efficient basis; and

(2) *the need to avoid unnecessary transaction costs.*

2.1.3 Assignment or re-assignment of customers to tariff classes

In accordance with clause 6.18.4 of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy is governed by the following customer reassignment principles:

6.18.4 Principles governing assignment or re-assignment of customers to tariff classes and assessment and review of basis of charging

(a) In formulating provisions of a distribution determination governing the assignment of customers to tariff classes or the re-assignment of customers from one tariff class to another, the AER must have regard to the following principles:

(1) customers should be assigned to tariff classes on the basis of one or more of the following factors:

(i) the nature and extent of their usage;

(ii) the nature of their connection to the network;

(iii) whether remotely-read interval metering or other similar metering technology has been installed at the customer's premises as a result of a regulatory obligation or requirement;

(2) customers with a similar connection and usage profile should be treated on an equal basis;

(3) however, customers with micro-generation facilities should be treated no less favourably than customers without such facilities but with a similar load profile;

(4) a Distribution Network Service Provider's decision to assign a customer to a particular tariff class, or to re-assign a customer from one tariff class to another should be subject to an effective system of assessment and review.

Note:

If (for example) a customer is assigned (or reassigned) to a tariff class on the basis of the customer's actual or assumed maximum demand, the system of assessment and review should allow for the reassignment of a customer who demonstrates a reduction or increase in maximum demand to a tariff class that is more appropriate to the customer's load profile.

(b) If the charging parameters for a particular tariff result in a basis of charge that varies according to the usage or load profile of the customer, a distribution determination must contain provisions for an effective system of assessment and review of the basis on which a customer is charged.

2.1.4 Pricing Principles

In accordance with 6.18.5 of the *Transitional Rules* Integral Energy must comply with the following pricing principles:

6.18.5 Pricing principles

(a) For each tariff class, the revenue expected to be recovered should lie on or between:

(1) an upper bound representing the stand alone cost of serving the customers who belong to that class; and

(2) a lower bound representing the avoidable cost of not serving those customers.

(b) A tariff, and if it consists of 2 or more charging parameters, each charging parameter for a tariff class:

(1) must take into account the long run marginal cost for the service or, in the case of a charging parameter, for the element of the service to which the charging parameter relates; and

(2) must be determined having regard to:

(i) transaction costs associated with the tariff or each charging parameter; and

(ii) whether customers of the relevant tariff class are able or likely to respond to price signals.

(c) If, however, as a result of the operation of paragraph (b), the Distribution

Network Service Provider may not recover the expected revenue, the provider must adjust its tariffs so as to ensure recovery of expected revenue with minimum distortion to efficient patterns of consumption.

2.1.5 Recovery of charges for transmission use of system services

In accordance with clause 6.18.7 of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy's pricing proposal must satisfy the following criteria:

6.18.7 Recovery of charges for transmission use of system services

(a) A pricing proposal must provide for tariffs designed to pass on to customers the charges to be incurred by the Distribution Network Service Provider for transmission use of system services.

(b) The amount to be passed on to customers for a particular regulatory year must not exceed the estimated amount of the transmission use of system charges for the relevant regulatory year adjusted for over or under recovery in the previous regulatory year.

(c) The extent of the over or under recovery is the difference between:

(1) the amount actually paid by the Distribution Network Service Provider by way of transmission use of system charges in the previous regulatory year; and

(2) the amount passed on to customers by way of transmission use of system charges by the Distribution Network Service Provider in the previous regulatory year.

2.2 Requirements of the AER's 2009 Determination

2.2.1 Weighted Average Price Cap

In accordance with section 4.6 of the *2009 determination*, Integral Energy must submit to the AER proposed tariffs and charging parameters which correspond to the price terms contained in the Weighted Average Price Cap (WAPC) equation as set out below.

$$\frac{\sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{k=1}^m p_{ik}^t \times q_{ik}^{t-2}}{\sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{k=1}^m p_{ik}^{t-1} \times q_{ik}^{t-2}} \leq (1 + \Delta CPI_t) \times (1 - X_t) \times (1 + D_t) \pm (\text{pass through}_t) \quad i = 1, \dots, n \text{ and } k = 1, \dots, m.$$

Where: The DNSP has 'n' relevant tariff classes which each have up to 'm' components:

p_{ik}^t is the proposed price for component 'k' of the relevant tariff 'i' for year 't'

p_{ik}^{t-1} is the actual price for component 'k' of the relevant tariff 'i' for year 't-1' (being the year which immediately precedes year 't')

q_{ik}^{t-2} is the audited¹⁹⁹ quantity of component 'k' of the relevant tariff 'i' that was charged by the DNSP in year 't-2' (being the year immediately preceding year 't-1')

X_t is the allowed real change in average prices from year 't-1' to year 't' of the regulatory control period as determined by the AER

D_t is the demand management cost recovery factor for year 't' calculated to recover certain approved demand management implementation costs and foregone revenue incurred in year 't-2',²⁰⁰

Pass through_t represents approved pass through amounts (expressed in percentage form) with respect to regulatory year 't' as determined by the AER under clause 6.6 of the transitional chapter 6 rules and chapter 15 of this final decision.

ΔCPI_t means the number derived, with respect to regulatory year 't', from the application of the following formula:

$$\Delta CPI_t = \frac{CPI_{March(t-2)} + CPI_{June(t-2)} + CPI_{September(t-1)} + CPI_{December(t-1)}}{CPI_{March(t-3)} + CPI_{June(t-3)} + CPI_{September(t-2)} + CPI_{December(t-2)}} - 1$$

2.2.2 Side Constraint

In accordance with section 4.6 of the *2009 determination*, Integral Energy must submit to the AER proposed tariffs and charging parameters which correspond to the price terms contained in the side constraint equation as set out below.

In accordance with the AER's guideline on control mechanisms for direct control services¹, the side constraints will be applied starting from the second regulatory year of the regulatory control period. Therefore, the tariff class side constraint is applicable to Integral Energy's tariffs for the regulatory years for commencing from 2010/11.

$$\frac{\sum_{k=1}^m d_k^t \times q_k^{t-2}}{\sum_{k=1}^m d_k^{t-1} \times q_k^{t-2}} \leq (1 + \Delta CPI_t) \times (1 - X_t) \times (1 + D_t) \times (1 + 2\%) \pm (\text{pass through}_t) \quad k = 1, \dots, m.$$

Where: The tariff class has up to 'm' components:

d_k^t is the proposed price for component 'k' of the tariff class for year 't'

d_k^{t-1} is the price charged by the DNSP for component 'k' of the tariff in year 't-1'

q_k^{t-2} is the audited quantity of component 'k' of the tariff that was charged by the DNSP in year 't-2'

X_t is the allowed real change in average prices from year 't-1' to year 't' of the regulatory control period as determined by the AER. If $X > 0$, then X will be set equal to zero for the purposes of the side constraint formula.

D_t is the demand management cost recovery factor for year 't' calculated to recover certain approved demand management implementation costs and foregone revenue incurred in year 't-2',²⁰¹

Pass through_t represents approved pass through amounts (expressed in percentage form) with respect to regulatory year 't' as determined by the AER under rule 6.6 of the transitional chapter 6 rules and chapter 15 of this final decision.

ΔCPI_t means the number derived, with respect to regulatory year 't', from the application of the following formula:

$$\Delta CPI_t = \frac{CPI_{March(t-2)} + CPI_{June(t-2)} + CPI_{September(t-1)} + CPI_{December(t-1)}}{CPI_{March(t-3)} + CPI_{June(t-3)} + CPI_{September(t-2)} + CPI_{December(t-2)}} - 1$$

¹ AER (2008) Final Decision on Control Mechanisms for Direct Control Services for the ACT and NSW 2009 Distribution Determinations, pg 12

2.2.3 Revenue requirement and X factors

The following table outlines the AER's final determination on Integral Energy's revenue requirements and pricing X factors for the *2009 regulatory control period*².

Table 2.1 – AER conclusion on annual revenue requirements and X factors (\$m, nominal)

	2008/09	2009/10	2010/11	2011/12	2012/13	2013/14
Regulatory Depreciation		144.3	123.2	119.7	113.4	106.1
Return on Capital		326.0	366.5	413.9	456.4	495.8
Tax Allowance		34.9	38.4	38.1	37.3	37.5
Operating Expenditure		304.8	314.8	327.4	339.7	346.8
Annual Revenue Requirements		809.9	843.0	899.2	946.8	986.1
Smoothed Revenues	652.8	749.9	828.4	919.0	984.8	1024.3
Forecast CPI (%)		2.47	2.47	2.47	2.47	2.47
X Factors ^a (%)		-12.58	-7.00	-7.00	-2.00	0.00

(a) Negative values for X indicate real price increases under the CPI-X formula.

² AER, *2009 distribution determination*, Table 16.27

Business Characteristics

3.1 Summary

Integral Energy is a NSW based state owned energy corporation, serving some of Australia's largest and fastest growing regional economies. It provides distribution network services to almost 850,000 customers, or 2.1 million people, in households and businesses across a network franchise spanning 24,500 square kilometres in Greater Western Sydney, the Blue Mountains, the Illawarra and the Southern Highlands.

In terms of customer segments, Integral Energy currently provides distribution network services to around 770,000 residential customers and 76,000 small business customers. There are also 3,700 large customers, with annual electricity consumption in excess of 160 MWh per annum, located within the Integral Energy network supply area.

In effectively managing distribution network services to these customers, Integral Energy must take account of a range of regional, climatic, customer, asset and licence requirement issues. Some of the key issues affecting Integral Energy's business include:

- The region in which Integral Energy operates includes some of Australia's fastest growing communities, in terms of population and growth. Population in the region is forecast to grow by 6% by 2013/14, while maximum demand for electricity is forecast to increase by 33% by 2013/14;
- Land use within the Integral Energy network supply region has also been steadily shifting from rural and semi-rural to urban and light commercial. As a result, customers now expect improved reliability performance in these areas;
- Peak temperatures within the Integral Energy network supply region are typically higher and more sustained than those of central Sydney and other coastal areas and, crucially, are more consistently experienced on an annual basis, meaning extreme weather events are more likely;
- Combined with these factors, the way Integral Energy's customers are using electricity has shifted rapidly over the last ten years. 81%³ of households in the Greater Western Sydney region are now fitted with air conditioning units, compared with 51% in the Illawarra and 50% in the Blue Mountains. This use has resulted in a peakier load pattern for Integral Energy in hot weather requiring

³

Based on customer survey analysis - iView Telephone Survey, June 2008.

more assets to service demand that only exists for a very small time frame each year;

- In addition to the increase in the penetration of air conditioning units, the uptake of other appliances such as in-home computers and entertainment systems has also increased. This trend is also changing consumption patterns, resulting in heightened customer expectations and awareness about reliability and security of supply;
- The impact of the continuing high growth rates and changing electricity patterns has meant deterioration in the overall system load factor; and
- From an asset perspective, in addition to operating in more extreme conditions, many of Integral Energy's assets are now nearing the end of their effective lives. This situation is illustrated in the age profile of power transformer assets, which indicates that 45% of these key assets have now been in service for 36 years or more. As a result, more assets are at risk of failing more often.

3.2 Integral Energy's business

Integral Energy is the second largest state owned energy corporation in NSW, incorporated under the Energy Services Corporations Act 1995 and currently operates as a licensed distribution network service provider and retailer under the terms of the Electricity Supply Act 1995.

Integral Energy's network is one of the largest in Australia and serves almost 850,000 customers, or 2.1 million people, across 24,500 square kilometres.

The network currently comprises over 28,400 transmission, zone and distribution substations and 312,650 power poles connected by 33,000 kilometres of underground and overhead lines.

Figure 3.1: Integral Energy's network



3.3 Characteristics of the region

Integral Energy's network covers the Greater Western Sydney, Blue Mountains, Illawarra and Southern Highlands areas. It includes the major cities of Parramatta, Penrith, Wollongong, Campbelltown, Blacktown and Liverpool and spans 18 local government areas.⁴

⁴ Lithgow, Hawkesbury, Blue Mountains, Penrith, Baulkham Hills, Blacktown, Parramatta, Fairfield, Holroyd, Liverpool, Camden, Campbelltown, Wollondilly, Wingecarribee, Wollongong, Shellharbour, Kiama, Shoalhaven

3.3.1 Regional growth and changing land use

Integral Energy supplies power to some of Australia's fastest growing communities, in terms of both population and load. Land use has been steadily moving from rural and semi-rural to generally urban and light commercial (but importantly not heavy industrial). This trend is continuing with new release areas in the north-west, including North Kellyville and Second Ponds Creek and new releases at the ADI site, Employment Lands at Eastern Creek and the south-west sector, such as Oran Park and Turner Road. The following aerial photos of Kellyville in Sydney's north-west between 1996 and 2005 are representative of the significant effect on Integral Energy's network required to service this change in land use.

Figure 3.2: Increasing urbanisation of region

Kellyville 1996



Kellyville 2005

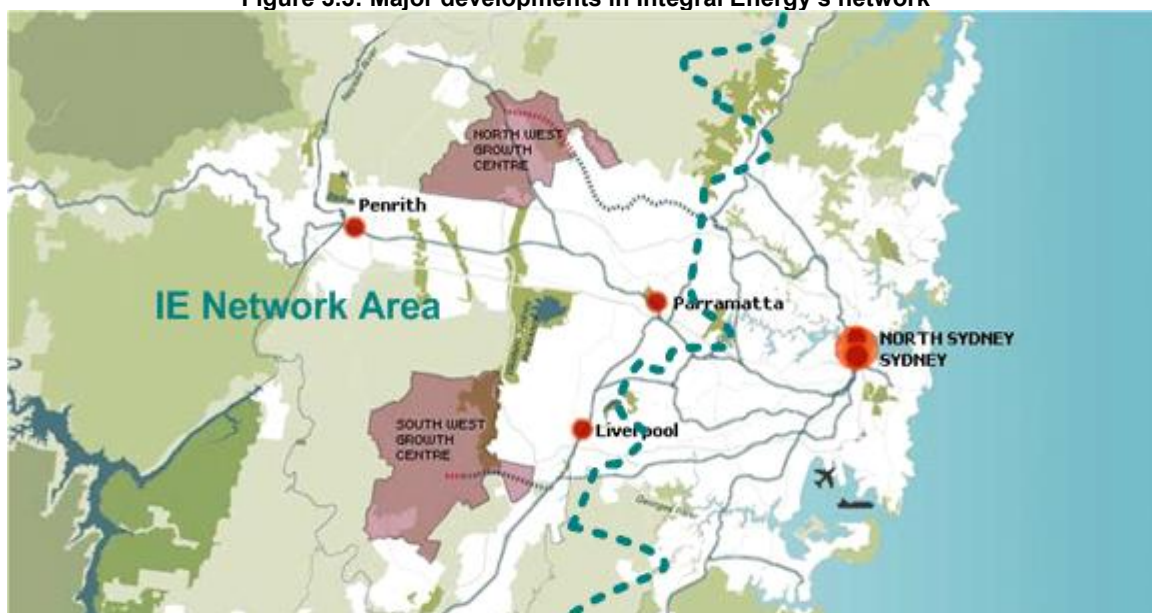


Major land releases are also occurring at Dapto and Shellcove in the Illawarra region. Combined with ongoing urban consolidation, these trends create pressure to raise network reliability performance from levels previously accepted as appropriate for rural areas, to levels now expected by customers in more densely populated urban areas.

In December 2004, the NSW Government announced the new land release plan for the South West and North West Growth Centres as a key plank of its Metropolitan Strategy for Sydney. The Growth Centres will accommodate 30% to 40% of Sydney's long term housing growth and will eventually accommodate 181,000 new dwellings. Both the South West and North West Growth Centres are encompassed wholly within Integral Energy's network franchise. Figure 2.3 highlights the scale and location of a number of the major land releases that fall within Integral Energy's franchise area.

These changes will have a significant impact on Integral Energy's network over the longer term. It is anticipated that the population serviced will grow 6% by 2013/14, increasing maximum demand by 33% by 2013/14 and requiring sustained investment in the network.

Figure 3.3: Major developments in Integral Energy's network



3.3.2 Regional climatic considerations

The Integral Energy distribution area, particularly the growth corridors to the west of Sydney, experience peak temperatures that are typically higher and more sustained than those of central Sydney and other coastal areas, and crucially are more consistently experienced on an annual basis by the network. There is a particularly high probability of experiencing extreme temperature events (in excess of 40°C) in each year in the west of Sydney.

The design temperature⁵ for meeting peak demand on the network in a standard summer is 41°C for the western regions in Integral Energy's network, compared to only 30°C for Integral Energy's coastal regions.

Moreover, in Integral Energy's distribution area, the extreme rating temperature for the system⁶ (similar to a 1 in 10 year type event) is only marginally higher at 43°C, so that there is relatively very little difference (just 2°C) between a standard summer peak temperature and an extreme summer peak temperature. This means there is a very high probability (almost certainty given design constraints) that there will be an extreme temperature experienced in any given year in the Integral Energy network. Integral Energy needs to invest in its network to ensure acceptable service standards under these extremes of load and temperature.

⁵ 50% Probability of Exceedance (PoE) – one in two year event.

⁶ Effectively the 10% probability of exceedance temperature.

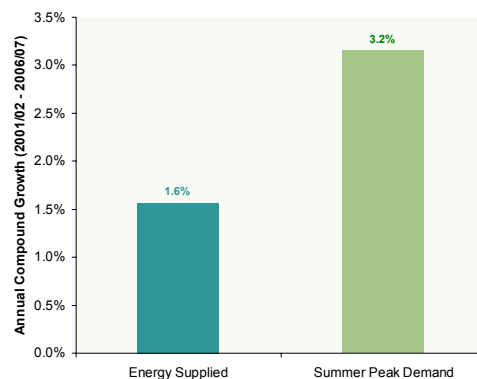
3.4 Integral Energy's customer and demand profile

Integral Energy serves around 770,000 residential customers, 76,000 small business customers and 3,700 large customers with annual electricity consumption in excess of 160 MWh pa.

3.4.1 Customer usage trends and the predominance of air conditioning

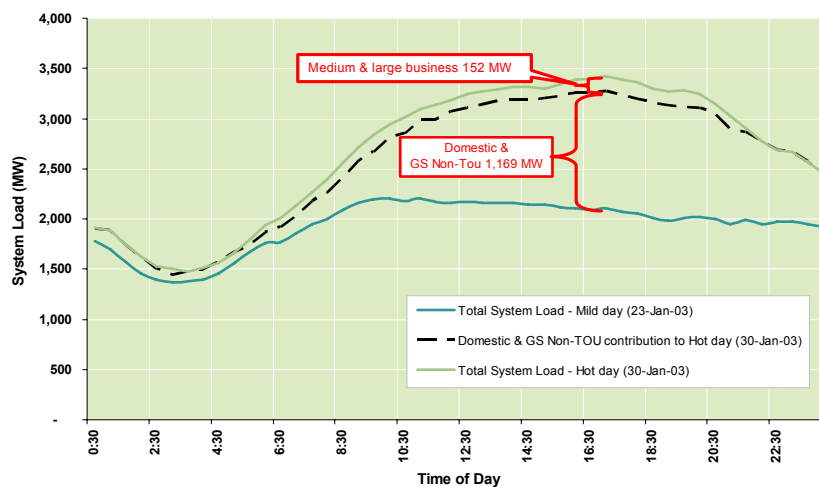
The way customers use electricity significantly affects the development of the electricity network. The higher and more sustained temperatures experienced in the west of Sydney primarily impact the peak demand growth rates for Integral Energy relative to the modest energy growth in household electricity consumption as highlighted in Figure 3.4.

Figure 3.4: Historical energy and demand growth rates



The increased uptake of air conditioning in new residential developments and the increasing penetration of air conditioning units into existing dwellings, coupled with an increasing air conditioning (kW) loading as customers become more accustomed to using refrigerated air in their homes, are all causing demand to increase at a faster rate than energy growth. This trend is expected to continue through the *2009 regulatory control period* before it ultimately plateaus with appliance saturation.

Figure 3.5 shows the effect of the air conditioning load on peak demand on an extreme temperature day relative to a mild summer day. As shown, the increase in load on an extreme temperature day is largely due to domestic and general supply non-time-of-use customers.

Figure 3.5: Contribution to summer peak by residential and commercial general supply customers

Even though these peak demands occur relatively infrequently, Integral Energy is still required to ensure that the network is capable of meeting this demand when it does occur. This means that many of the network assets are used only to service the air conditioning demand of households during the extreme weather events and only for very short periods e.g. typically less than 85 hours per year.

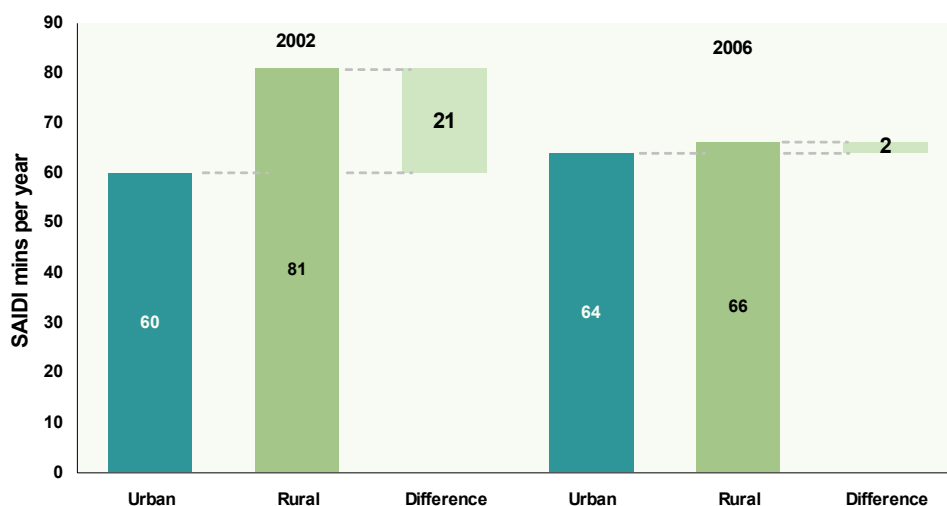
3.4.2 Customer service expectations

Customer expectations about network reliability are increasing. Integral Energy commissioned research studies into customer expectations of reliability in 2002 and again in 2006. This study involved choice modelling to understand the level of electricity reliability that customers were willing to trade off against other offerings.

The research shows that while urban customers' expectations have remained steady, rural customers' expectations about the number and duration of outages have changed significantly to a point where they are now very similar to those of urban customers. This trend in customer expectations is shown in Figure 3.6 and is consistent with the increasing use of home computers and other technology.

Integral Energy recognises the increased expectations of rural customers. The NSW DRP Licence Conditions establish interruption duration and frequency standards that apply to Integral Energy feeders and customers. Integral Energy has established a program to ensure that rural feeders are operated to comply with these conditions.

Figure 3.6: Urban and rural customer expectations – SAIDI⁷ minutes per year without supply (average)

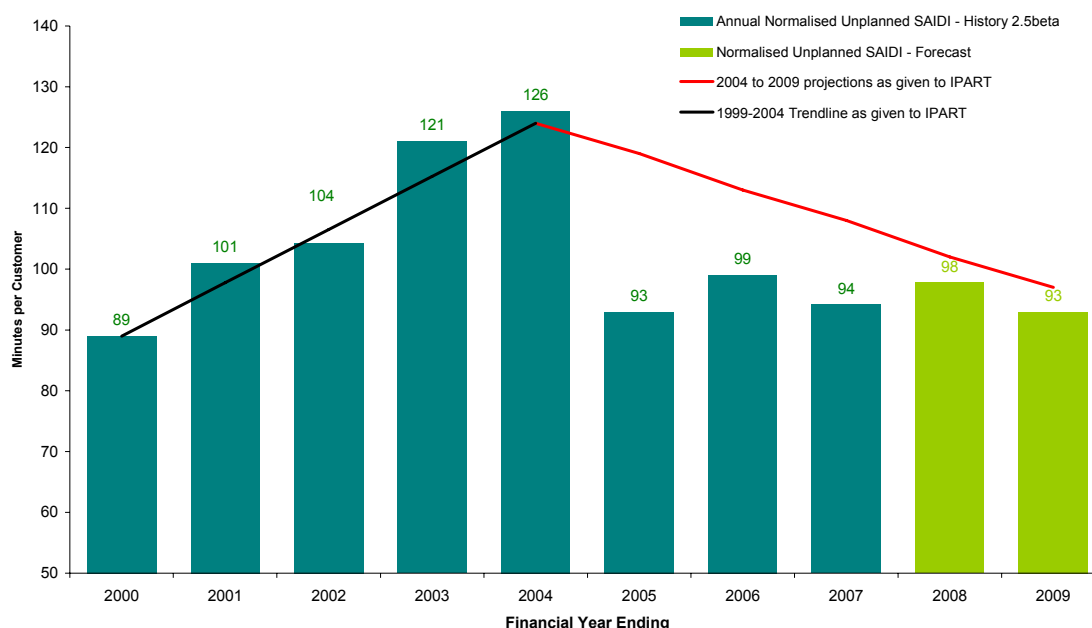


3.4.3 Network reliability over the 2004 to 2009 regulatory control period

Improving reliability performance has been one of the key drivers of expenditure in the *current regulatory control period* as Integral Energy has improved customer reliability outcomes after successfully arresting the deterioration in the reliability of its network. The total system average interruption duration index (SAIDI) measures the time, in minutes, that an average customer is without power in a given year. This is an important measure of an electricity distribution network's performance.

Over the period 1999/00 to 2003/04, Integral Energy customers had experienced declining performance, reaching a SAIDI of 126 minutes in 2003/04, after which reliability improved by more than 20%. The improvement in reliability has been achieved through a combination of targeted maintenance and capital initiatives. Integral Energy's 2004 regulatory submission set out plans to continue to focus on improving performance in its worst performing areas (continuing a strategy that commenced in 2002), by managing load at risk and planning for and replacing aged network assets. These plans were implemented and network reliability improved as shown in Figure 3.7.

⁷ System Average Interruption Duration Index

Figure 3.7: Network reliability performance

Note: SAIDI outcomes are normalised using the 2.5 Beta method. Note that the targets and trendline submitted to IPART for the 2004 Determination have been adjusted from the SCNRMR method to the 2.5 Beta method.

These characteristics serve to highlight some of the key factors that Integral Energy has considered in developing its Network Tariff Strategy. Integral Energy's Tariff Strategy is underpinned by its network planning and expenditure forecasting processes and articulates the future priorities for the network business. The process for developing the Network Tariff Strategy and ensuring that Integral Energy is appropriately prepared to respond to these issues is discussed further in Chapter 5.

Tariff Classes

4.1 Regulatory requirements

In accordance with clause 6.18.3 of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy must satisfy the following criteria with respect to tariff classes:

6.18.3 Tariff classes

- (a) *A pricing proposal must define the tariff classes into which customers for direct control services are divided.*
- (b) *Each customer for direct control services must be a member of 1 or more tariff classes.*
- (c) *Separate tariff classes must be constituted for customers to whom standard control services are supplied and customers to whom alternative control services are supplied (but a customer for both standard control services and alternative control services may be a member of 2 or more tariff classes).*
- (d) *A tariff class must be constituted with regard to:*
 - (1) *the need to group customers together on an economically efficient basis; and*
 - (2) *the need to avoid unnecessary transaction costs.*

4.2 Summary of Tariff Classes

Integral Energy's network use of system tariffs represent an aggregation of distribution use of system tariffs, climate change fund recovery tariffs and transmission cost recovery tariffs. Integral Energy's tariff classes are applicable to all of the above mentioned tariffs.

The following table provides a summary of Integral Energy's standard control services tariff classes⁸.

⁸ Integral Energy's Alternate Control Services are discussed in Chapter 13 of this pricing proposal

Table 4.1 – Integral Energy’s network tariff classes

Tariff Class	Pricing Options	Connection Characteristics
Low Voltage Energy	Residential Inclining Block Tariff	LV Connection; <160MWh pa
	Residential Time of Use	LV Connection; <160MWh pa
	General Supply Inclining Block Tariff	LV Connection; <160MWh pa
	General Supply Time of Use	LV Connection; <160MWh pa
	Controlled Load 1	LV Connection; <160MWh pa
	Controlled Load 2	LV Connection; <160MWh pa
Low Voltage Demand	LV TOU Demand	LV Connection; >160MWh pa but <40GWh or 10MVA
	LV TOU Demand Transition Tariff	LV Connection; >160MWh pa but <40GWh or 10MVA
High Voltage Demand	HV TOU Demand	HV Connection; >160MWh pa but <40GWh or 10MVA
	Individually Calculated	HV Connection; >40GWh or 10MVA
Subtransmission Demand	ST TOU Demand	ST Connection; >160MWh pa but <40GWh or 10MVA
	Individually Calculated	ST Connection; >40GWh or 10MVA
Inter-Distributor Transfers Demand	Individually Calculated	Distributor Transfer
Unmetered Supply	Streetlighting	Unmetered
	Nightwatch	Unmetered

Integral Energy has defined tariff classes with respect to:

- The nature and extent of customers’ usage;
- The nature of the customers’ connection to the network; and
- Whether remotely-read interval metering or other similar metering technology has been installed at the customer’s premises as a result of a regulatory obligation or requirement.

Integral Energy believes that this definition of tariff classes represents an economically efficient tariff class assignment that will avoid the need for unnecessary transaction costs.

4.3 Low Voltage Energy Tariff Class

4.3.1 Residential inclining block tariff – N70

The residential inclining block tariff (IBT) applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, is less than 160MWh;
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Low Voltage (LV) - nominally 230/400 V.

In addition, the residential IBT is predominantly used for one or more of the following purposes:

- private dwellings;
- boarding and lodging houses, being any house in which three or more persons exclusive of the family of the proprietor thereof are lodged for hire or reward from week to week or for more than a week;
- retirement villages;
- residential sections of nursing homes and hospitals;
- residential sections of educational institutions;
- children's homes;
- approved baby health centres, day nurseries and kindergartens;
- churches, mosques, temples etc., being buildings or properties which are used principally for public worship or partly for public worship and partly for educational purpose; or
- approved caravan sites

The residential IBT is applied where the connection point has an accumulation (basic or disc - Type 6) meter or an interval meter that is read as a Type 6 meter.

The residential IBT comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa), and
- two variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a First Block Rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to electricity consumption (kWh) up to and including 1,750 kWh per quarter; and

-
- b) a Second Block Rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to electricity consumption (kWh) above 1,750 kWh per quarter.

4.3.2 Residential time of use (type 5) tariff – N705

The residential time of use (type 5) tariff applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, is less than 160MWh;
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Low Voltage (LV) - nominally 230/400 V;
- A capital contribution for the meter is payable by the customer; and
- The interval meter records 30 minute intervals.

The residential time of use (type 5) tariff applies to a property, which is predominantly used for one or more of the purposes set out in section 4.3.1 at a *supply point* with a time of use meter from which interval meter data is obtained. Type 5 tariffs are applicable to supply points with a Type 5 (manually read interval) meter installed.

The residential time of use (type 5) tariff comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa), and
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;
 - b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period;
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period;

The time of day period definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.3.3 Residential time of use tariff – N706

The residential time of use tariff applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, is less than 160MWh;
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Low Voltage (LV) - nominally 230/400 V.; and

-
- The interval meter records a single “peak”, “shoulder” and “off peak” interval per billing period.

The residential time of use tariff applies to a property, which is predominantly used for one or more of the purposes set out in section 4.3.1 at a *supply point* with a time of use meter from which interval meter data is obtained.

The residential time of use tariff comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa), and
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period ;
 - b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period; and
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period.

The distinctions between this TOU tariff (N706) and the Type 5 TOU Tariff (N705) discussed above are that:

- only three periods (one each for Peak, Shoulder and Off-Peak) are recorded for each meter reading cycle under tariff N706, rather than 48 periods per day (i.e. 30 minute intervals) that are collected for the Type 5 TOU Tariff (N705); and
- a capital contribution is payable for the meter under the Type 5 TOU Tariff (N705).

The time of day period definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.3.4 General supply inclining block tariff – N90

The general supply inclining block tariff (IBT) applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, is less than 160MWh;
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Low Voltage (LV) - nominally 230/400 V.

The general supply IBT applies to low voltage electricity used for any purpose other than Residential, at a *supply point* with an accumulation meter or an interval meter that is read as a Type 6 meter.

The general supply IBT comprises the following components:

-
- a Network Access Charge (\$pa), and
 - two variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a First Block Rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to electricity consumption (kWh) up to and including 2,500 kWh per quarter; and
 - b) a Second Block Rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to electricity consumption (kWh) above 2,500 kWh per quarter.

4.3.5 General supply time of use (type 5) – N845

The general supply time of use (type 5) tariff applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, is less than 160MWh;
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Low Voltage (LV) - nominally 230/400 V;
- A capital contribution for the meter is payable by the customer; and
- The interval meter records 30 minute intervals.

The general supply time of use (type 5) tariff applies to a property, which is predominantly used for any purpose other than residential at a *supply point* with a time of use meter from which interval meter data is obtained. Type 5 tariffs are applicable to supply points with a Type 5 (manually read interval) meter installed

The general supply time of use (type 5) tariff comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa), and
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;
 - b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period;
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period ;

The time of day period definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.3.6 General supply time of use – N84

The general supply time of use tariff applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

-
- total electricity consumption, per financial year, is less than 160MWh;
 - electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Low Voltage (LV) - nominally 230/400 V; and
 - The interval meter records a single “peak”, “shoulder” and “off peak” interval per billing period.

The general supply time of use tariff applies to a property, which is predominantly used for any purpose other than residential at a *supply point* with a time of use meter from which interval meter data is obtained.

The general supply time of use tariff comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa), and
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;
 - b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period; and
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period;

The distinctions between this General Supply TOU tariff (N84) and the General Supply Type 5 TOU Tariff (N845) discussed above are that:

- only three periods (one each for Peak, Shoulder and Off-Peak) are recorded for each meter reading cycle under tariff N84, rather than 48 periods per day (i.e. 30 minute intervals) that are collected for the Type 5 TOU Tariff (N845); and
- a capital contribution is payable for the meter under the Type 5 TOU Tariff (N705).

The time of day period definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.3.7 Controlled load tariffs – N50 and N54

A control load tariff applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, is less than 160MWh;
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Low Voltage (LV) - nominally 230/400 V; and
- A Residential or general supply tariff also applies

A controlled load tariff applies where electricity load is separately metered and controlled at a *supply point* with an accumulation meter.

- a) Controlled Load 1 applies where specified appliances are controlled by our equipment so that supply may not be available between 7:00am and 10:00pm; and
- b) Controlled Load 2 applies where our equipment controls approved specified appliances so that electricity is available for restricted periods not exceeding a total of 17 hours in any period of 24 hours.

Switching times will be managed to minimise network investment and meet customer needs for the load being controlled.

Customers with a Controlled Load relay are entitled to a controlled load network price only if all of the following conditions are met:

- a) Controlled Load consumption is separately metered using the same type of meter as the uncontrolled portion of a customer's load;
- b) Controlled Load consumption and uncontrolled load consumption is always synchronously read, i.e. on the same day; and
- c) the Controlled Load is operated by our load control systems or time switches.

A controlled load tariff is applicable only to approved appliances as detailed in Appendix 2 of Integral Energy's Network Price List.

The controlled load 1 and 2 tariffs comprise of the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa), and
- an Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to electricity consumption (kWh)

4.4 Low Voltage Demand Tariff Class

4.4.1 Low voltage time of use demand – N19

The low voltage time of use demand tariff applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, greater than 160MWh but less than 40 GWh or 10MVA;
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Low Voltage (LV) - nominally 230/400 V; and

-
- there exists a time of use meter, from which both interval meter energy and demand data is obtained.

The low voltage time of use demand tariff comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa);
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;
 - b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period;
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period;
- two variable demand components consisting of:
 - d) a High-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the High-Season Peak period; and
 - e) a Low-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the Low-Season Peak period;

The time of day and season definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.4.2 Transitional time of use – N89

The transition time of use tariff applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, greater than 160MWh but less than 40 GWh or 10MVA;
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Low Voltage (LV) - nominally 230/400 V; and
- there exists a time of use meter, from which at a minimum interval meter energy data is obtained.

The Transitional time of use tariff applies to those customers on a Low Voltage Energy Tariff Class tariff who have been identified as consuming in excess of 160MWh per annum, and therefore requiring a demand based tariff, but cannot be directly transferred to the low voltage time of use demand tariff due to a lack of metering capable of supporting the demand based tariff or the expected bill impact of a direct transition to low voltage time of use demand is deemed excessive.

The transitional time of use tariff comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa), and
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;
 - b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period; and
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period;

The time of day period definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.5 High Voltage Demand Tariff Class

4.5.1 High voltage time of use demand – N29

The high voltage time of use demand tariff applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, greater than 160MWh but less than 40 GWh or 10MVA; and
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as High Voltage (HV) - nominally 12.7 kV SWER, 11 or 22 kV.

The high voltage time of use demand tariff comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa);
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;
 - b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period;
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period;
- two variable demand components consisting of:

-
- d) a High-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the High-Season Peak period; and
 - e) a Low-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the Low-Season Peak period;

The time of day and season definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.5.2 Individually calculated high voltage time of use demand tariffs

Individually calculated high voltage time of use demand tariffs apply to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as High Voltage (HV) - nominally 12.7 kV SWER, 11 or 22 kV; and
- electricity consumption has been equal to or greater than 100 GWh in total for the 36 months preceding the application; or
- electricity consumption has been equal to or greater than 40 GWh per annum in each of the two financial years preceding the application; or
- monthly peak demand has been equal to or greater than 10 MVA for 24 of the 36 months preceding the application.

Integral Energy may assign a individually calculated high voltage time of use demand tariff to any *supply point* in circumstances such as, but not limited to:

- The need to recover investment associated with stranded or dedicated assets, or other cost caused to Integral Energy by the customer at that supply point, which may otherwise not be recovered under the high voltage time of use demand tariff;
- Integral Energy agrees to assign an individually calculated high voltage time of use demand tariff following an application from the customer, or a retail supplier acting on their behalf, to be assigned to an individually calculated high voltage time of use demand tariff.

Individually calculated high voltage time of use demand tariffs comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa);
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;

-
- b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder;
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period;
 - two variable demand components consisting of:
 - d) a High-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the High-Season Peak period; and
 - e) a Low-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the Low-Season Peak period;

The time of day and season definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.6 Subtransmission Voltage Demand Tariff Class

4.6.1 Subtransmission time of use demand – N39

The subtransmission time of use demand tariff applies to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- total electricity consumption, per financial year, greater than 160MWh but less than 40 GWh or 10MVA; and
- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Sub-Transmission (ST) - 33, 66 or 132 kV.

The subtransmission time of use demand tariff comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa);
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;
 - b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period;
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period;
- two variable demand components consisting of:

-
- d) a High-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the High-Season Peak period; and
 - e) a Low-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the Low-Season Peak period;

The time of day and season definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.6.2 Individually calculated subtransmission voltage tariffs

Individually calculated subtransmission time of use demand tariffs apply to *connection services* and *network use-of-system services* supplied to the supply point where:

- electricity is supplied at a voltage level defined as Sub-Transmission (ST) - 33, 66 or 132 kV; and
- electricity consumption has been equal to or greater than 100 GWh in total for the 36 months preceding the application; or
- Electricity consumption has been equal to or greater than 40 GWh per annum in each of the two financial years preceding the application; or
- Monthly peak demand has been equal to or greater than 10 MVA for 24 of the 36 months preceding the application.

Integral Energy may assign an individually calculated subtransmission time of use demand tariff to any *supply point* in circumstances such as, but not limited to:

- The need to recover investment associated with stranded or dedicated assets, or other cost caused to Integral Energy by the customer at that supply point, which may otherwise not be recovered under the subtransmission time of use demand tariff;
- Integral Energy agrees to assign an individually calculated subtransmission time of use demand tariff following an application from the customer, or a retail supplier acting on their behalf, to be assigned to an individually calculated high voltage time of use demand tariff.

Individually calculated subtransmission time of use demand tariffs comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa);
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - a) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;

-
- b) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period;
 - c) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period;
 - two variable demand components consisting of:
 - d) a High-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the High-Season Peak period;
 - e) a Low-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the Low-Season Peak period;

The time of day and season definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.7 Inter-Distributor Transfer Tariff Class

Inter-distributor transfer tariffs are calculated on an individual basis and are specifically applied to electricity transferred through the Integral Energy network on behalf of EnergyAustralia and Country Energy.

Inter-distributor transfer tariffs comprises the following components:

- a Network Access Charge (\$pa);
- three variable energy components consisting of:
 - f) a Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Peak period;
 - g) a Shoulder Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Shoulder period;
 - h) an Off-Peak Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to the consumption of electricity in the Off-Peak period;
- two variable demand components consisting of:
 - i) a High-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the High-Season Peak period; and
 - j) a Low-Season Peak Demand rate, expressed on a \$/maximum kVA/month basis, applied to the consumption of electricity in the Low-Season Peak period;

The time of day and season definitions are outlined in Appendix H.

4.8 Unmetered Supply Tariff Class

Unmetered Supply tariffs are applicable to *supply points* that are not metered. Energy consumption is calculated using the appropriate algorithm in the applicable Metrology Procedure.

Unmetered tariffs comprise of an Energy rate, expressed on a ¢/kWh basis, to be applied to calculated electricity consumption (kWh).

4.9 Miscellaneous, monopoly service and emergency recoverable works charges

4.9.1 Miscellaneous service charges

In accordance with Appendix H of the *2009 distribution determination*, Distribution Network Service Providers can levy various charges for services defined as miscellaneous services.

Integral Energy's miscellaneous service charges are provided in Chapter 6 of this *pricing proposal*.

4.9.2 Monopoly service charges

In accordance with Appendix H of the *2009 distribution determination*, Distribution Network Service Providers can levy various charges for services defined as monopoly services.

Integral Energy's monopoly service charges are provided in Chapter 6 of this *pricing proposal*.

4.9.3 Emergency recoverable works

In accordance with Appendix H of the *2009 distribution determination*, Distribution Network Service Providers can levy various charges for services defined as emergency recoverable works.

Integral Energy's charges for emergency recoverable works charges are provided in Chapter 6 of this *pricing proposal*.

Network Tariff Strategy

5.1 Network Tariff Objectives

To provide a high-level framework for network tariff strategy development the following network pricing objectives have been adopted:

Table 5.1– Network Pricing Objectives

Network Pricing Objective	Driver
Revenue sufficiency	Fund our investment programs and ensure that Integral Energy recovers the regulated revenue allowance.
Revenue volatility	Actively seek to minimise monthly and annual revenue variations where practical.
Pricing efficiency	Signal the economic cost of network utilisation and recover fixed/sunk costs in a manner that causes the least distortion to price signals.
Customer equity	Ensure customers only pay for their fair share of costs and that any moves to cost reflectivity are introduced in a socially responsible manner.

5.2 The Need for Tariff Reform

Air conditioning demand is highly sensitive to peak summer temperatures, has very poor power factors and occurs when the system is significantly de-rated because of high summer temperatures. Increased air-conditioning load and its impact on peak demand is one of the key drivers of Integral Energy's network investment.

Capacity in Integral's network must be built to meet maximum peak load unless demand can be managed or reduced. Capacity requirements for new estates have effectively doubled as a result of air conditioning load on peak demand – network design parameters, for example, have changed from 3.5 to 4.0 kVA to 6.0 to 7.5 kVA per household.

New houses are estimated to have approximately 60% to 70% penetration of large ducted air conditioning. Similarly there is a high take-up of air conditioning occurring in some existing areas as split systems in particular have become more affordable in recent years.

Modelling undertaken by Charles River Associates⁹ (CRA) for Integral Energy using a long run marginal cost approach for capital investment to meet peak demand indicates that the cross-subsidy between customers with air conditioning and those without air conditioning is in the range \$80 to \$110 million per year – or approximately one third of total sales to the residential and small business sectors.

If this subsidy is smeared across all of the remaining consumption by these groups it equates to 1.5 cents/kWh to 2.0 cents/kWh relative to the marginal rate.

5.3 Network Tariff Strategy

Integral Energy's pricing is designed in part to signal the costs associated with increased demand placed on the network, including the use of air conditioning, within metering and efficiency constraints.

Consistent with the network tariff objectives outlined above, Integral Energy's network tariff strategy aims to:

- Attain revenue sufficiency under the Weighted Average Price Cap;
- Signal the long run marginal cost of supply through its network tariffs;
- Improve cost reflectivity and reduce revenue variability by reducing the reliance on usage based tariff components where appropriate;
- Pass the cost of TransGrid's transmission services through to customers; and
- Explore tariff based demand management opportunities, including voluntary time of use tariffs, and tariffs that target network constraints on a locational basis (see section 5.6 for future tariff reform options under consideration).

5.4 Tariff Reform 2004 to 2009

Over the 2004 to 2009 determination period, Integral Energy has undertaken a number of tariff reforms, including the following:

- The introduction of the Inclining Block Tariff (IBT) Structure for residential and general supply customers;
- The introduction of a time of use tariff options for residential customers to complement the IBT;
- A new time of day (peak, shoulder and off-peak) period definition to better reflect current and expected patterns of network utilisation;

⁹ CRA (2003), Impact of Air Conditioning on Integral Energy's Network.

-
- The ongoing assignment of eligible customers to the low voltage time of use demand network tariff; and
 - The introduction of seasonal peak demand charging to better reflect current and expected patterns of network utilisation.

5.5 Experimental Tariff Programs

Integral Energy's Western Sydney Pricing Trial commenced on 1 August 2006 and will operate until 31 July 2009. The trial involves approximately 1,300 residential customers from the Western Sydney region of Integral Energy's network. These customers have been placed on either a Seasonal Peak Time of Use Tariff or Dynamic Peak Price Time of Use Tariff.

Those customers on the Dynamic Peak Pricing tariff were then broken into two treatment groups, one with an in home display unit and one without. A further group of customers on the default tariff were identified as a control group against which the tariff treatment groups could be compared.

The purpose of the trial is to test more sophisticated time of use pricing signals, in particular their:

- Effectiveness as a demand management tool;
- Acceptance by customers;
- Cost of administration; and
- Financial viability as a network-wide time of use tariff option.

The key results for the Dynamic Peak Time of Use Tariff (DPP) to date are:

- A demonstrable reduction in consumption relative to the control group during the peak period 1-8pm on days when a dynamic peak event was called;
- A marginal conservation of energy for the entire period of the trial.
- No demonstrable response relative to the control group during shoulder and off peak periods;
- Customers do not appear to have shifted consumption from the peak to the off peak period;
- Customer response does not appear to vary during a dynamic peak event according to whether customers are given 2 hours or 24 hours notification of an impending event;
- Customer response does not appear to vary during a dynamic peak event if customers are subjected to continuous events called over several days;

-
- Some evidence that providing customers on the dynamic peak tariff with an in-home display monitor will result in an additional 3% reduction in consumption during a dynamic peak event, however this diminished over time;

The results for the Seasonal Peak Time of Use Tariff are still being assessed; however, a much reduced response rate is evident relative to the DPP trial.

Integral Energy plans to continue to undertake research with respect to customer response to price signals in order to move to more efficient prices in the medium term that signal the costs imposed on the network by customers in times of peak demand.

5.6 Future Tariff Reform Options

Integral believes that there may be significant benefits to be realised from continuing the network tariff reform process and in obtaining more first-hand information on customers usage of the network through trials and associated customer research. Integral's key focus will be on the following network tariff reforms:

- Improving the design of Integral's network time of use (TOU) tariffs, particularly in the potential lead-up to a mandated rollout of interval meters;
- Strengthening the IBT price signal as a "second best" option to TOU pricing where TOU meters are not available;
- Assigning more customers to network demand tariffs where it is economically efficient to do so;
- Examining locational pricing signals, including nodal pricing at higher voltage levels, to ensure prices reflect the costs of congestion on the network; and
- Explore tariff based demand management opportunities.

5.7 Expected DUOS Price Trends 2009 - 2014

Integral Energy's weighted average DUOS price is expected to increase over the *2009 regulatory control period* at the rate governed by the weighted average price cap X factors and *tariff class* side constraints as determined by the AER in the *2009 distribution determination*.

In accordance with clause 6.18.9(a)(3) of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy believes that in satisfying the regulatory requirements as demonstrated in Chapter 8 of this *pricing proposal* and implementing the above tariff strategy, customers can expect the following DUOS *charging parameter* movements relative to the weighted average price movement allowed by the AER in the *2009 distribution determination* over the *2009 regulatory control period*.

Table 5.2 - Indication of future DUOS tariff charging parameter movements relative to the average price movement allowed by the AER in the 2009 distribution determination

DUOS Tariff	Fixed Charge	First Block Price	Second Block Price	Uniform Energy Price	Peak Energy Price	Shoulder Energy Price	Off-Peak Energy Price	High Season Maximum Demand	Low Season Maximum Demand
Residential IBT	▲	▼	▲						
Controlled Load 1	▲			▼					
Controlled Load 2	▲			▼					
Residential TOU	▲				▲	▼	—		
General Supply IBT	▲	▲	▲						
General Supply TOU	▲				▲	▼	—		
LV TOU Demand	▲				▲	▼	—	▲	▼
HV TOU Demand	▲				▲	▼	—	▲	▼
ST TOU Demand	▲				▲	▼	—	▲	▼

Legend:

- ▲ increase relative to the average distribution price movement allowed by the AER in the *2009 distribution determination*
- ▼ decrease relative to the average distribution price movement allowed by the AER in the *2009 distribution determination* (i.e. lower than the average distribution price increase, but may still result in a real increase at the component level)
- set at the average distribution price movement allowed by the AER in its *2009 distribution determination*
- A blank section indicates that the charging parameter is not applicable for this tariff

6

Network use of system tariffs

6.1 Calculation of Network Use of System Tariffs

Integral Energy's network use of system tariffs represent the aggregation of distribution use of system tariffs, climate change fund recovery tariffs and transmission cost recovery tariffs.

6.2 Low Voltage Energy Tariff Class

6.2.1 Residential inclining block tariff – N70

The following table shows the proposed prices for the default residential inclining block tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.1 – Proposed 2009/10 residential inclining block tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	76.65	91.25	19.05%
First Block Energy Charge (c/kWh)	6.6190	7.8922	19.24%
Second Block Energy Charge (c/kWh)	7.7450	9.4752	22.34%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.2.2 Residential time of use (type 5) – N705

The following table shows the proposed prices for the residential time of use tariff (type 5) for 2009/10.

Table 6.2 – Proposed 2009/10 residential time of use (type 5) tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	208.05	251.85	21.05%
Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	7.8374	9.6566	23.21%
Shoulder Energy Charge (c/kWh)	7.8374	9.4132	20.11%
Off Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	4.7863	5.8930	23.12%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.2.3 Residential time of use – N706

The following table shows the proposed prices for the residential time of use tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.3 – Proposed 2009/10 residential time of use tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	113.95	138.70	21.72%
Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	11.1308	13.6086	22.26%
Shoulder Energy Charge (c/kWh)	7.2965	8.6777	18.93%
Off Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	2.6035	3.3181	27.45%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.2.4 General supply inclining block tariff – N90

The following table shows the proposed prices for the default general supply inclining block tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.4 – Proposed 2009/10 general supply inclining block tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	76.65	102.20	33.33%
First Block Energy Charge (c/kWh)	5.4925	6.7991	23.79%
Second Block Energy Charge (c/kWh)	6.3025	8.0317	27.44%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.2.5 General supply time of use (type 5) – N845

The following table shows the proposed prices for the general supply time of use tariff (type 5) for 2009/10.

Table 6.5 – Proposed 2009/10 general supply time of use (type 5) tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	208.05	259.15	24.56%
Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	6.7070	8.4317	25.71%
Shoulder Energy Charge (c/kWh)	6.7070	8.0471	19.98%
Off Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	5.0608	6.0572	19.69%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.2.6 General supply time of use – N84

The following table shows the proposed prices for the general supply time of use tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.6 – Proposed 2009/10 general supply time of use tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	127.75	160.60	25.71%
Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	9.2635	11.7808	27.17%
Shoulder Energy Charge (c/kWh)	6.7055	8.4788	26.45%
Off Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	2.2208	3.0405	36.91%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.2.7 Controlled load tariffs – N50 and N54

The following table shows the proposed prices for the controlled load 1 tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.7 – Proposed 2009/10 controlled load 1 tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	7.30	10.95	50.00%
Energy Charge (c/kWh)	0.5181	0.5040	-2.72%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

The following table shows the proposed prices for the controlled load 2 tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.8 – Proposed 2009/10 controlled load 2 tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	7.30	10.95	50.00%
Energy Charge (c/kWh)	2.0219	2.2670	12.12%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.3 Low Voltage Demand Tariff Class

6.3.1 Low voltage time of use demand – N19

The following table shows the proposed prices for the low voltage time of use demand tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.9 – Proposed 2009/10 low voltage time of use demand tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	2,613.40	3,266.75	25.00%
Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	2.2505	3.5019	55.61%
Shoulder Energy Charge (c/kWh)	1.4072	2.4509	74.17%
Off Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	0.6129	0.8239	34.43%
Seasonal Peak Demand Charge (\$/kVA/Month)	8.5956	10.1388	17.95%
Non Seasonal Peak Demand Charge (\$/kVA/Month)	8.2003	9.5931	16.98%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.3.2 Transitional time of use – N89

The following table shows the proposed prices for the transitional time of use tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.10 – Proposed 2009/10 transitional time of use tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	2,613.40	3,266.75	25.00%
Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	9.3430	11.8193	26.50%
Shoulder Energy Charge (c/kWh)	5.3173	6.9065	29.89%
Off Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	0.7281	0.9389	28.95%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.4 High Voltage Demand Tariff Class

6.4.1 High voltage time of use demand – N29

The following table shows the proposed prices for the high voltage time of use demand tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.11 – Proposed 2009/10 high voltage time of use demand tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	4,325.25	5,405.65	24.98%
Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	1.6034	2.6533	65.48%
Shoulder Energy Charge (c/kWh)	1.0925	2.0284	85.67%
Off Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	0.5406	0.7453	37.87%
Seasonal Peak Demand Charge (\$/kVA/Month)	6.2050	7.3675	18.73%
Non Seasonal Peak Demand Charge (\$/kVA/Month)	5.9223	6.9762	17.80%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.4.2 Individually calculated high voltage tariffs

The individually calculated high voltage NUOS tariffs have been provided to the AER on a confidential basis as Appendix E of this *pricing proposal*.

6.5 Subtransmission Voltage Demand Tariff Class

6.5.1 Subtransmission time of use demand – N39

The following table shows the proposed prices for the subtransmission time of use demand tariff for 2009/10.

Table 6.12 – Proposed 2009/10 subtransmission time of use demand tariff

Charging Parameter	Existing NUOS Tariff	Proposed NUOS Tariff	% change
	2008/09	2009/10	
Network Access Charge (\$pa)	6,796.30	8,493.55	24.97%
Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	1.5104	2.4103	59.58%
Shoulder Energy Charge (c/kWh)	1.0569	1.8265	72.82%
Off Peak Energy Charge (c/kWh)	0.4830	0.6659	37.87%
Seasonal Peak Demand Charge (\$/kVA/Month)	4.7669	5.6735	19.02%
Non Seasonal Peak Demand Charge (\$/kVA/Month)	4.5501	5.3700	18.02%

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

6.5.2 Individually calculated subtransmission voltage tariffs

The individually calculated subtransmission voltage NUOS tariffs have been provided to the AER on a confidential basis as Appendix E of this *pricing proposal*.

6.6 Inter-Distributor Transfer Tariff Class

The inter-distributor NUOS tariffs have been provided to the AER on a confidential basis as Appendix E to this *pricing proposal*.

6.7 Unmetered Supply Tariff Class

The unmetered supply NUOS tariffs have been provided to the AER on a confidential basis as Appendix E to this *pricing proposal*.

6.8 Miscellaneous, monopoly and emergency recoverable works service charges

6.8.1 Miscellaneous service charges

Integral Energy's miscellaneous service charges are consistent with Appendix H of the 2009 distribution determination and are shown in the following table.

Table 6.13 – Charges for miscellaneous services

Miscellaneous Service	\$
Special Meter Reading	44
Meter Test	73
Supply of Conveyancing Information – Desk Inquiry	37
Supply of Conveyancing Information – Field Visit	73
Off-peak Conversion	59
Disconnection Visit (Acceptable Payment Received)	44
Disconnection at Meter Box	88
Disconnection at Pole Top/Pillar Box	148
Rectification of Illegal Connection	221
Reconnection Outside Business Hours	95

All prices in the above table are exclusive of GST

[illegible]

6.8.3 Emergency recoverable works

Integral Energy will levy charges emergency recoverable works in a manner consistent with Appendix H of the 2009 distribution determination as provided below:

H.5.1 Changes for emergency recoverable works

- a. *The charge that a DNSP may levy for emergency recoverable works must not exceed the sum of the following:*
 - i. *110 per cent of the costs (other than labour costs) actually incurred in providing the emergency recoverable works and*
 - ii. *The cost of labour actually used to undertake the emergency recoverable works determined by applying 150 per cent of the R2 labour rate for that labour.*
- b. *For the avoidance of doubt, in the application of section H.5.1(a)(2), where a DNSP retains labour for a specified period for the purpose of that labour undertaking emergency recoverable works, the DNSP may only charge for so much of that specified period during which the labour actually undertakes the emergency recoverable works. For example, if a DNSP retains labour for a minimum specified period of four hours and the time required to actually undertake the emergency recoverable works is only one hour, the DNSP may only charge for the one hour and not the four hours.*

Customer Impacts

The customer impacts presented in this chapter are calculated using Integral Energy's proposed NUOS tariffs. The use of network tariffs result in customer impacts that include increases to DUOS, climate change fund recovery and transmission cost recovery tariffs.

All customer impacts presented in this chapter are GST exclusive and have been calculated on the basis that historic customer energy consumption levels and patterns are indicative of 2009/10 consumption levels and patterns.

The distribution of impacts is provided where the number of customers on the tariff is sufficient and the data is available to provide a meaningful analysis.

7.1 Low Voltage Energy Tariff Class

7.1.1 Residential inclining block tariff – N70

The following table shows the expected network bill impacts of the proposed network price change for customers on the residential inclining block tariff.

Table 7.1 – Customer impact residential inclining block tariff

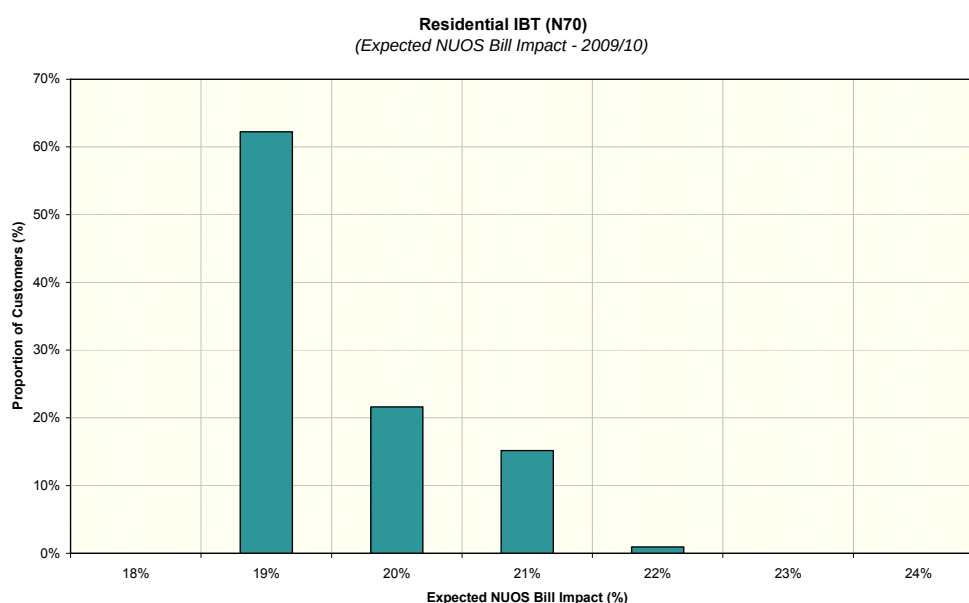
Annual Consumption	NUOS Bill		Change in NUOS Bill (%)
	2008/09	2009/10	
2,000	209.03	249.09	19.2%
4,000	341.41	406.94	19.2%
6,000*	473.79	564.78	19.2%
10,000	772.33	927.96	20.2%
15,000	1,159.58	1,401.72	20.9%

All indicative bill outcomes in the above table are exclusive of GST

() Approximate annual consumption of an average sized customer*

The following figure shows the impact distribution of the proposed network price change for customers on the residential inclining block tariff¹⁰.

¹⁰ Customer distribution based on historic (03/04) data

Figure 7.1 – Expected residential inclining block tariff NUOS bill impact distribution

7.1.2 Residential time of use (type 5) – N705

The following table shows the expected network bill impacts of the proposed network price change for customers on the residential time of use (type 5) tariff.

Table 7.2 – Customer impact residential time of use (type 5)

Annual Consumption	NUOS Bill		Change in NUOS Bill (%)
	2008/09	2009/10	
4,000	444.84	541.33	21.7%
8,000	681.62	830.81	21.9%
12,000*	918.41	1,120.29	22.0%
16,000	1,155.20	1,409.77	22.0%
20,000	1,391.99	1,699.26	22.1%

All indicative bill outcomes in the above table are exclusive of GST

() Approximate annual consumption of an average sized customer*

7.1.3 Residential time of use – N706

The following table shows the expected network bill impacts of the proposed network price change for customers on the residential time of use tariff.

Table 7.3 – Customer impact residential time of use

Annual Consumption	NUOS Bill		Change in NUOS Bill (%)
	2008/09	2009/10	
10,000	618.21	758.02	22.6%
30,000	1,626.72	1,996.66	22.7%
45,000*	2,383.10	2,925.64	22.8%
60,000	3,139.48	3,854.62	22.8%
80,000	4,148.00	5,093.26	22.8%

All indicative bill outcomes in the above table are exclusive of GST

() Approximate annual consumption of an average sized customer*

7.1.4 General Supply inclining block tariff – N90

The following table shows the expected network bill impacts of the proposed network price change for customers on the general supply inclining block tariff.

Table 7.4 – Customer impact general supply inclining block tariff

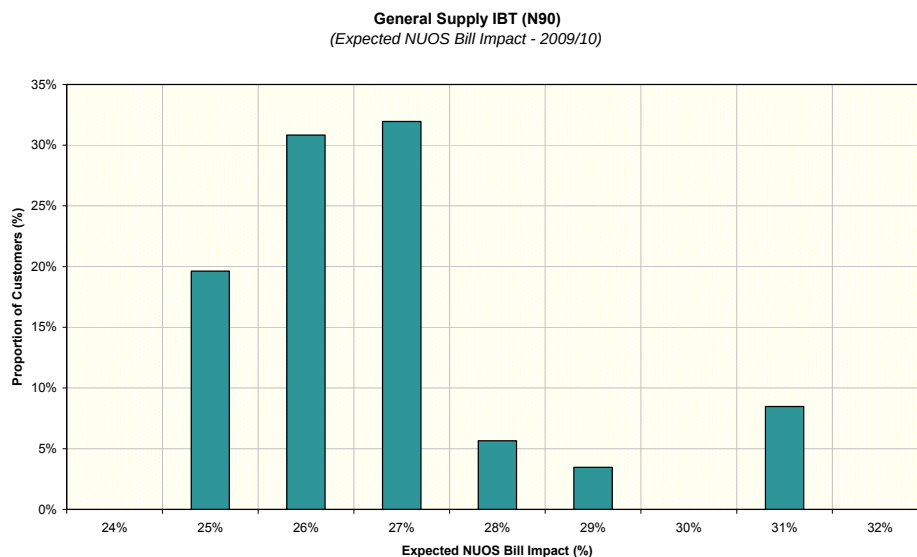
Annual Consumption	NUOS Bill		Change in NUOS Bill (%)
	2008/09	2009/10	
5,000	351.28	442.16	25.9%
10,000	625.90	782.11	25.0%
26,000*	1,634.30	2,067.18	26.5%
40,000	2,516.65	3,191.62	26.8%
60,000	3,777.15	4,797.96	27.0%

All indicative bill outcomes in the above table are exclusive of GST

() Approximate annual consumption of an average sized customer*

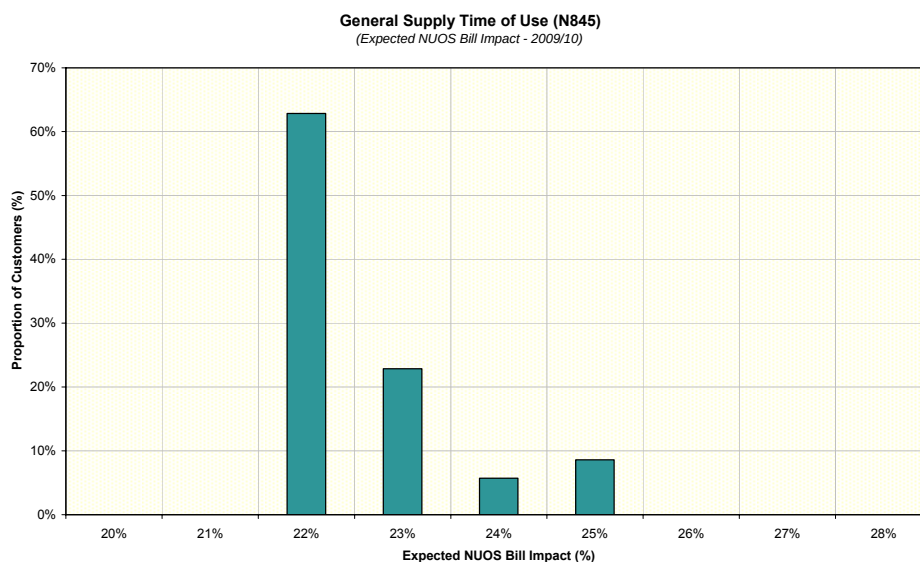
The following figure shows the impact distribution of the proposed network price change for customers on the general supply inclining block tariff¹¹.

¹¹ Customer distribution based on historic (03/04) data

Figure 7.2 – Expected general supply inclining block tariff NUOS bill impact distribution

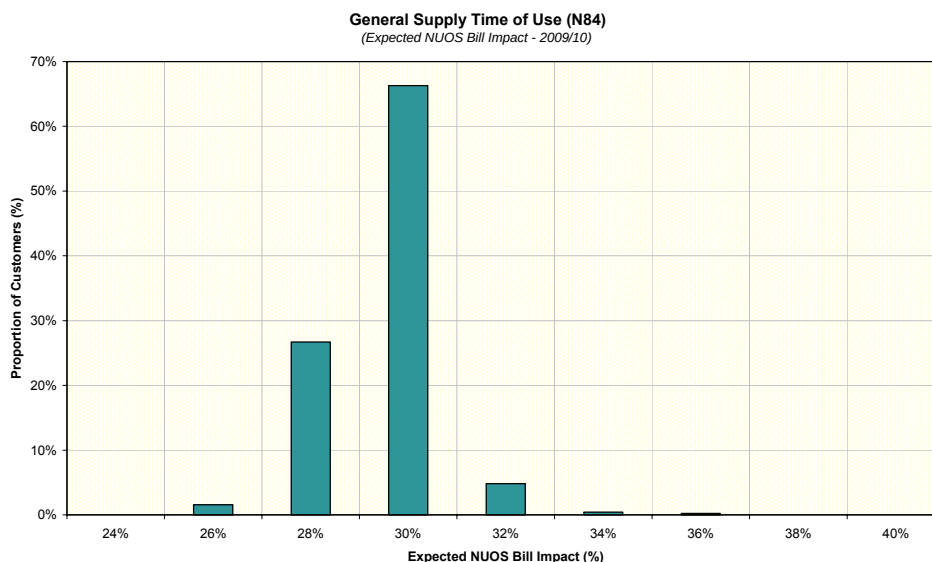
7.1.5 General supply time of use (type 5) – N845

The following figure shows the impact distribution of the proposed network price change for customers on the general supply time of use (type 5) tariff.

Figure 7.3 – Expected general supply time of use (type 5) NUOS bill impact distribution

7.1.6 General supply time of use – N84

The following figure shows the impact distribution of the proposed network price change for customers on the general supply time of use tariff.

Figure 7.4 – Expected general supply time of use NUOS bill impact distribution

7.1.7 Controlled load tariffs – N50 and N54

The following table shows the expected network bill impacts of the proposed network price change for customers on the controlled load 1 tariff.

Table 7.5 – Customer impact Controlled Load 1

Annual Consumption	NUOS Bill		Change in NUOS Bill (%)
	2008/09	2009/10	
1,000	12.48	15.99	28.1%
3,000*	22.84	26.07	14.1%
5,000	33.21	36.15	8.9%
10,000	59.11	61.35	3.8%

All indicative bill outcomes in the above table are exclusive of GST

() Approximate annual consumption of an average sized customer*

The following table shows the expected network bill impacts of the proposed network price change for customers on the controlled load 2 tariff.

Table 7.6 – Customer impact Controlled Load 2

Annual Consumption	NUOS Bill		Change in NUOS Bill (%)
	2008/09	2009/10	
1,000	27.52	33.62	22.2%
3,000*	67.96	78.96	16.2%
5,000	108.40	124.30	14.7%
10,000	209.49	237.65	13.4%

All indicative bill outcomes in the above table are exclusive of GST

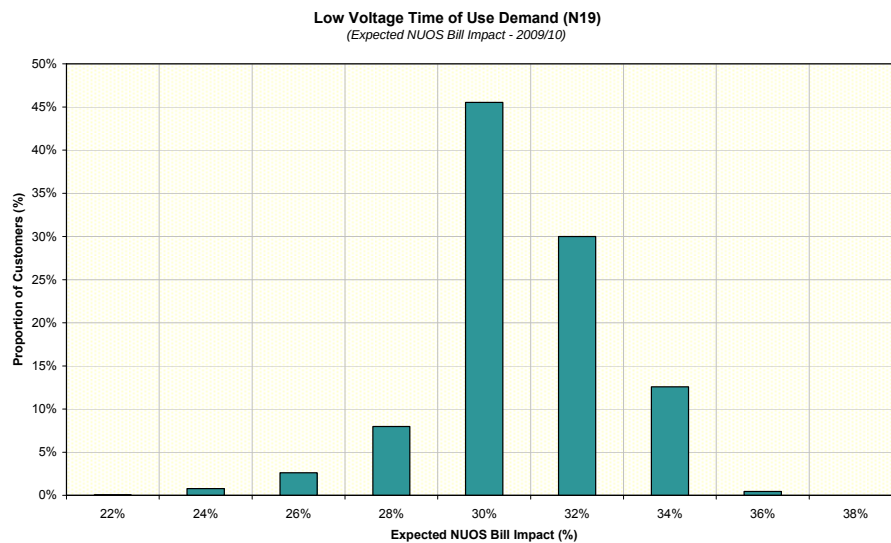
() Approximate annual consumption of an average sized customer*

7.2 Low Voltage Demand Tariff Class

7.2.1 Low voltage time of use demand – N19

The following figure shows the impact distribution of the proposed network price change for customers on the low voltage time of use demand tariff.

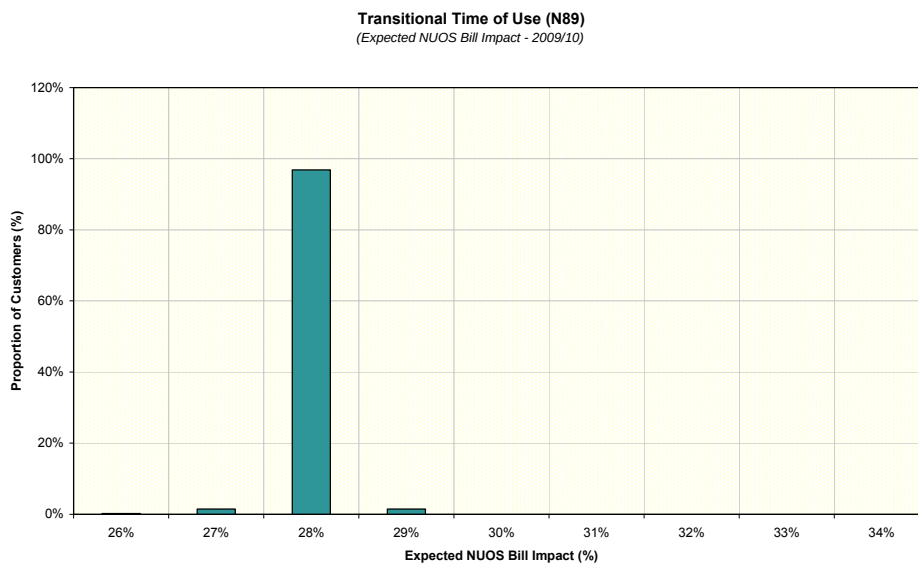
Figure 7.5 – Expected low voltage time of use demand NUOS bill impact distribution



7.2.2 Transitional time of use – N89

The following figure shows the impact distribution of the proposed network price change for customers on the transmission time of use tariff.

Figure 7.6 – Expected transition time of use NUOS bill impact distribution

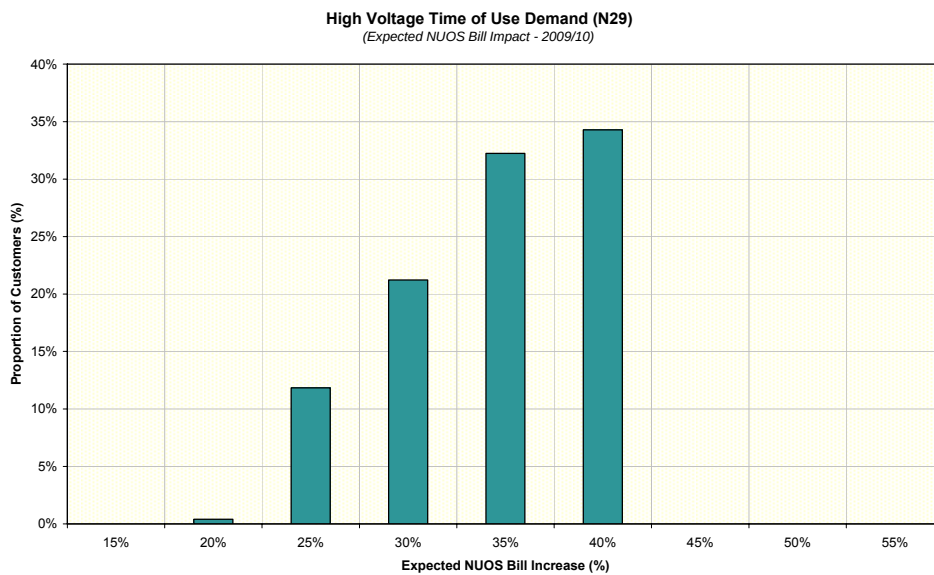


7.3 High Voltage Demand Tariff Class

7.3.1 High voltage time of use demand – N29

The following figure shows the impact distribution of the proposed network price change for customers on the high voltage time of use demand tariff.

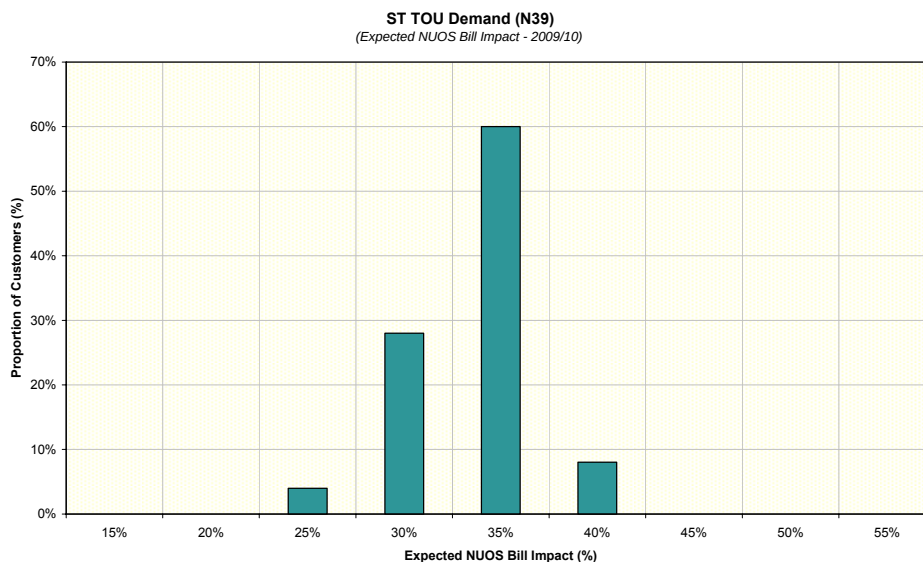
Figure 7.7 – Expected high voltage time of use demand NUOS bill impact distribution



7.4 Subtransmission Voltage Demand Tariff Class

7.4.1 Subtransmission time of use demand – N39

The following figure shows the impact distribution of the proposed network price change for customers on the subtransmission time of use demand tariff.

Figure 7.8 – Expected subtransmission time of use demand NUOS bill impact distribution

7.5 Unmetered Supply Tariff Class

The following table shows the expected network bill impacts of the proposed network price change for customers on the unmetered streetlighting tariff.

Table 7.7 – Customer impact unmetered streetlighting tariff

Annual Consumption	NUOS Bill		Change in NUOS Bill (%)
	2008/09	2009/10	
1,000	54.60	67.44	23.5%
3,000	163.79	202.31	23.5%
5,000	272.99	337.18	23.5%
10,000	545.97	674.36	23.5%
20,000	1,091.94	1,348.72	23.5%

All indicative bill outcomes in the above table are exclusive of GST

Compliance with Regulatory Requirements

8.1 2009/10 Compliance Requirements

The following table summarises the 2009/10 network pricing compliance criteria.

Table 8.1 – Pricing compliance factors

Compliance Item	2009/10 Criteria
Consumer Price Index	4.35% ¹²
X Factor	-12.58%
D Factor	0.4% ¹³
WAPC $((1+CPI)*(1-X)*(1+D)-1)$	17.95%

8.2 Compliance with the Weighted Average Price Cap

The following table demonstrates that Integral's 2009/10 network pricing proposal complies with the weighted average price cap (WAPC) X factor constraint outlined in the 2009 distribution determination. The table also satisfies clause 6.18.2 (b) (4) of the *Transitional Rules*.

¹² Calculated in accordance with section 4.6 of the 2009 distribution determination

¹³ As advised by the AER

Table 8.2 – Compliance with the weighted average price cap

Tariff Class	Existing Weighted Average Revenue 2008/09 (\$'000)	Proposed Weighted Average Revenue 2009/10 (\$'000)	Change in Weighted Average Revenue (%)	Weighted Average Price Cap Constraint (%)
Low Voltage Energy	461,786	544,395	17.89%	
Low Voltage Demand	116,996	137,892	17.86%	
High Voltage Demand	30,497	35,907	17.74%	
Subtransmission Demand	20,069	23,594	17.56%	
Inter-Distributor Transfers	4,225	4,963	17.46%	
Unmetered Supply	5,568	6,533	17.33%	
Miscellaneous and Monopoly Fees	6,950	8,781	26.35%	
Total	646,091	762,064	17.95%	17.95%
Do the proposed DUOS tariffs meet the WAPC criterion?				Yes

8.3 Compliance with tariff class side constraints

In accordance with the AER's guideline on control mechanisms for direct control services¹⁴, the side constraints will be applied starting from the second regulatory year of the regulatory control period, and do not, therefore, apply to tariff classes in 2009/10.

8.4 Pricing Principles

In accordance with 6.18.5 of the *Transitional Rules* Integral Energy must comply with the following pricing principles:

6.18.5 Pricing principles

(a) For each tariff class, the revenue expected to be recovered should lie on or between:

(1) an upper bound representing the stand alone cost of serving the customers who belong to that class; and

(2) a lower bound representing the avoidable cost of not serving those customers.

(b) A tariff, and if it consists of 2 or more charging parameters, each charging parameter for a tariff class:

¹⁴ AER (2008) Final Decision on Control Mechanisms for Direct Control Services for the ACT and NSW 2009 Distribution Determinations, pg 12

(1) must take into account the long run marginal cost for the service or, in the case of a charging parameter, for the element of the service to which the charging parameter relates; and

(2) must be determined having regard to:

(i) transaction costs associated with the tariff or each charging parameter; and

(ii) whether customers of the relevant tariff class are able or likely to respond to price signals.

(c) If, however, as a result of the operation of paragraph (b), the Distribution Network Service Provider may not recover the expected revenue, the provider must adjust its tariffs so as to ensure recovery of expected revenue with minimum distortion to efficient patterns of consumption.

8.5 Compliance with Avoidable and Stand Alone Cost Requirements

8.5.1 Definition of Avoidable and Stand Alone Cost

Integral Energy engaged CEG to provide an external review of Integral Energy's avoidable and stand alone cost calculation methodology and model.

CEG has provided Integral Energy with two definitions of avoidable and stand alone cost.

The first hypothesises the different costs associated with building a new network with and without the relevant customer class. This approach ignores the sunk nature of the existing network and calculates costs as follows:

- **Avoidable cost for tariff class A** - total cost of building and operating the network that Integral Energy would design to serve all customers less total cost of building and operating the network that Integral would design to serve all customers except those in tariff class A; and
- **Stand alone cost for tariff class A** - total cost of building and operating the network that Integral Energy would design to serve only the customers in tariff class A.

The second is to acknowledge the existence of the network as it presently stands today and to calculate standalone/avoidable taking the existing network design as a given. Under this approach costs are calculated as follows:

- **Avoidable cost for tariff class A** - total cost to Integral Energy of using the existing network to serve all customers less total cost to Integral Energy of using the existing network to serve all customers except those in tariff class A; and
- **Stand alone cost for tariff class A** - total cost to Integral of using the existing network to serve only the customers in tariff class A.

CEG note that the second definition involves a more ‘real world’ definition of avoidable costs. Namely, it is the costs that would actually be avoided if a set of customers did not need to be served (rather than the hypothetical costs that would have been avoided if that set of customers had never existed).

The *Transitional Rules* are not prescriptive about the methodology used to calculate avoidable and stand alone cost. However, given a regulatory framework which recognises the existence and value of sunk costs and does not, in general, seek to conduct ex-post optimisation on the structure of the *Distribution Network Service Provider’s* networks, one may reasonably conclude that the second method is consistent with the general approach set out in the *Transitional Rules*.

Integral Energy has adopted the second method for this *pricing proposal*, as detailed in the following section.

CEG is satisfied that Integral Energy’s:

- methodology for calculating avoidable and stand alone costs; and
- the model used to calculate avoidable and stand alone costs at the *tariff class*.

meet the requirements of section 6.18.5(a) of the *Rules*.

The CEG review of Integral Energy’s avoidable and stand alone cost methodology and model is provided in Appendix I.

8.5.2 Avoidable and Stand Alone Cost Methodology

To estimate standalone costs, Integral Energy’s *Regulatory Cost of Supply Model* makes an allocation of all costs (network and overhead costs) to each tariff class. Through this allocation, the stand alone cost of serving each separate tariff class must sum to the standalone cost of serving all customers. The implicit assumption underlying this calculation is that there are no economies of scale or scope in the provision of electricity networks. Since it is clear that there are economies of scale and scope and that they are material, CEG concludes that Integral Energy’s stand alone costs will be materially higher than those estimated in its model.

Similarly, Integral Energy’s model makes an allocation of all ‘direct’ (or causative) costs to estimate the level avoidable costs for each tariff class. These do not include overheads such as motor vehicles and information technology systems but do include a full allocation of all network assets and network operating and maintenance costs. Again, this assumes that there are no economies of scale or scope in relation to network assets (since each tariff class must bear a proportional share of direct costs with the proportions summing to unity). In effect, the only costs that are not treated as avoidable are overheads. Taking into account the existence of such economies of scale, CEG concludes that Integral Energy’s avoidable costs will be materially lower than those estimated in its model.

Given that Integral Energy's proposed revenues fall between the bounds of avoidable and stand alone cost as estimated in its Regulatory Cost of Supply Model, and for the reasons set out above, CEG are of the opinion that the approach meets the *Rule* requirements. That is, amendments to Integral Energy's estimates would cause these bounds to widen, rather than to narrow. Given that Integral Energy already estimates that its revenues fits within these 'too narrow' bounds CEG concludes that Integral Energy's revenues would similarly fall within the broader bounds that would more accurately reflect stand alone and avoidable costs.

Accordingly, CEG has concluded that they are satisfied that Integral Energy's pricing meets the requirements of section 6.18.5(a) of the *Transitional Rules*.

8.5.3 Calculation of Avoidable and Stand Alone Cost

Table 8.3 – avoidable and stand alone cost calculation

Tariff Class	Expected DUOS Revenue (\$'000)	Avoidable Cost (\$'000)	Stand Alone Cost (\$'000)	Between Avoidable and Stand Alone Cost?
Low Voltage Energy	562,641	443,338	688,287	Yes
Low Voltage Demand	119,557	35,693	280,642	Yes
High Voltage Demand	35,047	14,048	213,698	Yes
Subtransmission Demand	23,389	13,178	161,857	Yes
Inter-Distributor Transfers	5,008	3,492	152,170	Yes
Unmetered Supply	6,482	1	244,950	Yes

Integral Energy's network tariff classes lie within the subsidy free range in that the expected DUOS revenue collected from the tariff class lies between the avoidable and stand alone costs of supply and therefore meet the requirements of section 6.18.5(a) of the *Transitional Rules*.

8.6 Long run marginal cost

8.6.1 External Review of the Long Run Marginal Cost Methodology

In 2005, Integral Energy commissioned National Economic Research Associates (NERA) to develop a report into the Long Run Marginal Cost (LRMC) of Electricity Distribution in Integral Energy's network area.

In preparing its *pricing proposal*, Integral Energy engaged CEG to provide an external review of Integral Energy's long run marginal cost methodology and model, both of which were developed on the basis of the NERA Report.

CEG has endorsed Integral Energy's:

- methodology for calculating long run marginal cost; and
- the model used to calculate long run marginal cost by tariff *charging parameter*.

The CEG review of Integral Energy's LRM Methodology and Model is provided in Appendix J.

8.6.2 Marginal Cost Pricing

The principle of marginal cost plays a central role in the formulation of economically efficient prices. If prices are set below marginal cost, resources will be wasted in meeting customers' demands which cost more than the benefits customers derive from them; and if prices are set above marginal cost, then they will discourage purchases by customers which would have been valued more than the cost to society of supplying them.

NERA¹⁵ notes that marginal costs are often differentiated according to whether they correspond to the short or long run. The distinction between these two categories has to do not with any specific length of time, but rather with the factors of production that are variable. The short run refers to a situation in which the investment in plant and equipment is fixed. Capacity can be neither added nor removed, although it can be used to a greater or lesser extent.

The short run marginal cost of electricity distribution is the cost to society of a customer using existing capacity in the network at any point in time. This is generally very low unless the system is capacity constrained¹⁶, and reflects the fact that the great majority of the costs of an electricity network provider are fixed in the short run and do not vary with the usage of the network. However, when the system is capacity constrained the marginal costs of usage can be very high.

It should be noted that these costs do not generally reflect increased costs to the network service provider but rather reflect the costs to society of "customer A" using the network and thereby preventing "customer B" from using the network. That is, when the system is constrained the costs of one customer using the network are equal to the benefits foregone by other customers who are unable to use the network.

These benefits foregone are generally measured as the maximum amount a customer who is constrained would have been willing to pay for the last available unit of capacity. By definition, this is equal to the market-clearing price for existing capacity. That is, the price at which existing capacity is rationed amongst potential users. When capacity is not constrained, as noted above, the market-clearing price is zero and therefore the short run marginal cost of congestion is also zero.

The long run refers to a situation in which the investment in plant and equipment is variable. Existing firms may add or remove capacity; firms may enter or exit the market. A long-run marginal cost therefore indicates how cost changes with respect to output or capacity when all factors of production including plant and equipment are variable. The

¹⁵ NERA (2005) Long Run Marginal Cost of Electricity Distribution - A Report for Integral Energy p 8-9

¹⁶ This abstracts from variable (demand related) operating and maintenance costs and, most significantly, the cost of electricity losses on the distribution system. The level of electricity losses imposed by a customer on the distribution system will also vary with the location of that customer in the network, the level of energy use by the customer and the level of capacity utilisation at the time of that energy use.

long run marginal cost then will relate broadly to the annualised cost of augmenting capacity (in the case of electricity, at a particular voltage, at a particular location, at a particular time), generally, per unit of additional capacity provided (ie, kW or kVA).

8.6.3 The importance of efficient pricing for network utilities

NERA¹⁷ note that the economies of scale or density applying to network utilities mean that supplying services at marginal cost may not be financially sustainable. This gives rise to a tension between economic efficiency and revenue adequacy. In such circumstances a firm differentiates its price so as to ensure:

- That the total quantity produced is as close as possible to the quantity that corresponds to the intersection of demand and marginal cost, while maintaining overall financial viability; and
- That any differences between average cost and marginal cost are recovered from those customers who have the least responsive demand (with respect to price movements) referred to as price elasticity.

The above approach to pricing enables DNSP's to recover their average costs while maintaining incentives to invest in maintaining and augmenting their networks.

In this case it is important that one *charging parameter* of the tariff reflects the marginal cost of supply (however defined), providing effective signals for allocative efficiency of existing capacity; and for a second *charging parameter* to recover the remaining costs required to ensure that the network service provider can recover the fixed costs of the network. It is important in structuring the tariff that the second *charging parameter* be levied so as to impose the least possible distortion to customers' consumption behaviour.

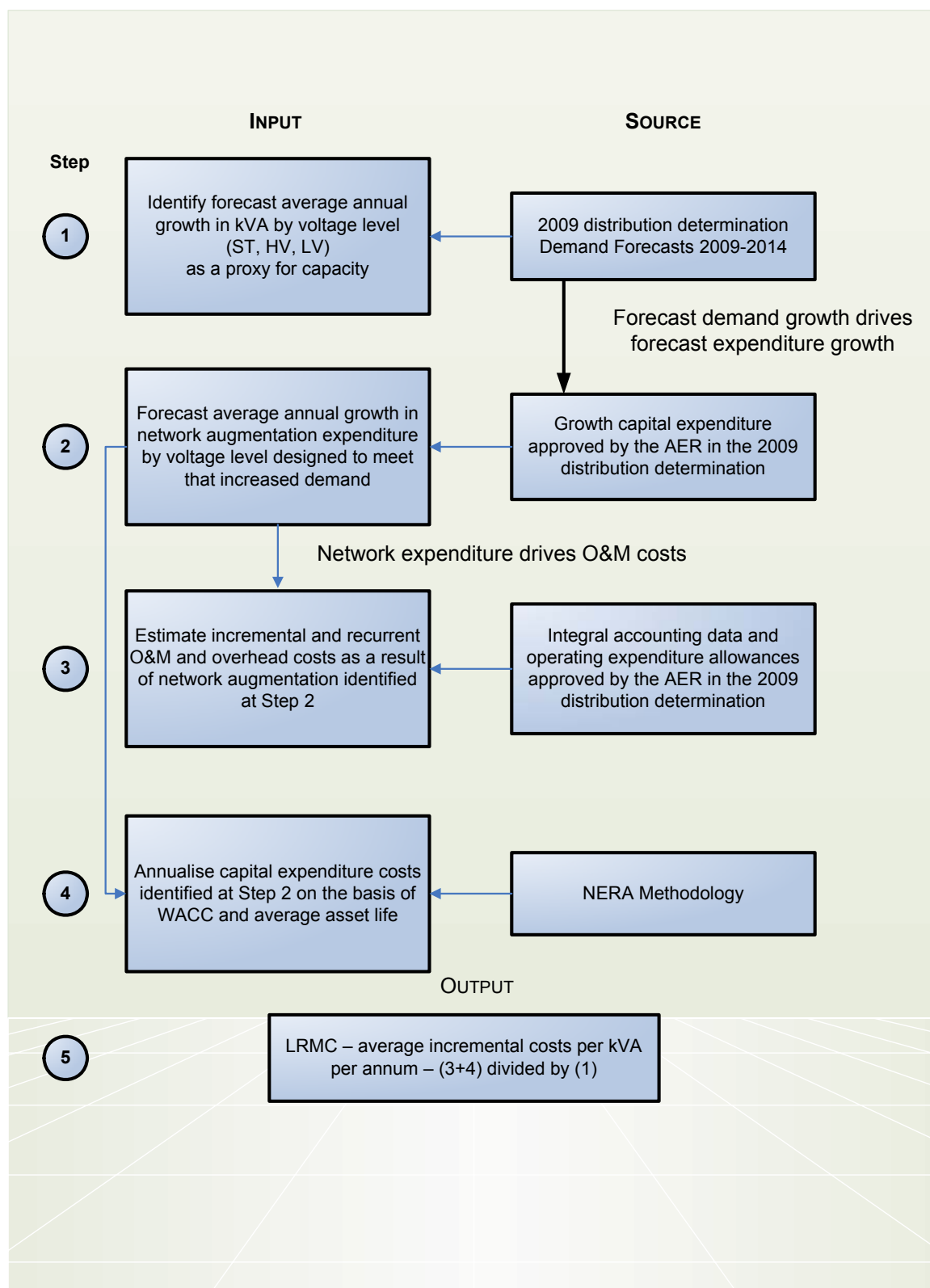
8.6.4 Long Run Marginal Cost Methodology

Integral Energy's long run marginal costs are calculated on a dollar per kVA per annum basis at the relevant voltage level. The methodology uses the AER's 2009 *distribution determination* demand forecast, capital expenditure and operating expenditure allowances.

The following schematic illustrates Integral Energy's methodology as advised by NERA and endorsed by CEG, to arrive at an estimate of Integral Energy's LRMC. The process has been divided into five separate steps:

¹⁷ NERA (2006), Distribution Pricing Rule Framework, *Network Policy Working Group*, p 9

Figure 8.1: LRMC Methodology - National Economic Research Associates



The following LRMC estimates represent the cost associated with meeting forecast growth in critical peak demand for apparent energy (kVA). Critical peak demand is any level of demand that, should it occur often enough, would trigger an increase in network augmentation under Integral Energy's network planning.

Table 8.4 – Voltage level LRMC calculation

Voltage Level	LRMC Calculation (\$/kVA/pa)
Low Voltage	267.75
High Voltage	67.50
Subtransmission	45.50

It should be noted that the values for low voltage and high voltage already include the long run marginal cost of upstream (higher voltage) costs caused by consumption at the lower voltage level.

The formulas used to allocate the above LRMC by voltage into tariff *charging parameter* rates and the resultant LRMC tariffs by *charging parameter* have been provided to the AER on a confidential basis as Appendix B to this proposal.

8.7 Transaction Costs

In accordance with clause 6.18.5(b)(2)(i) of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy attempts to minimise any transaction costs arising from its network tariffs by limiting the complexity of the tariff structure and *charging parameters* within each tariff. The *charging parameters* applicable to each tariff are provided in Chapter 4 of this *pricing proposal* while more detailed information of Integral Energy's tariffs and *charging parameters* are provided in the Network Price List available on the Integral Energy website.

Integral Energy has not introduced new tariffs or tariff structures in 2009/10 and as such, transaction costs will not be increased as a result of the implementation of this *pricing proposal*.

8.8 Response to Price Signals

In accordance with clause 6.18.5(b)(2)(ii) of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy notes that efficiency gains of marginal cost pricing are realised when the tariff, based on the marginal cost of supply, induces a behavioural change in the customer¹⁸. To maximise this customer response Integral Energy signals the long run marginal cost of supply through those tariff *charging parameters* with the greatest price elasticity of demand, namely the variable consumption charges that are based on the customers energy use and maximum demand.

¹⁸ NERA (2006), Distribution Pricing Rule Framework, *Network Policy Working Group*, p 31 - 35

Consistent with the principles of efficient pricing (section 8.6.3), and in accordance with clause 6.18.5(c) of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy recovers the shortfall between marginal cost and average cost from those charging parameters with the lowest price elasticity of demand, namely the fixed *charging parameter*, thus minimising the distortion the long run marginal cost signal inherent in Integral Energy's variable *charging parameters* and maximising the probability of efficiency gains realised through customer behaviour response to efficient price signals.

Climate change fund

9.1 Regulatory Requirement

In accordance with clause 6.18.2(b)(5A) of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy's pricing proposal must:

6.18.2 Pricing proposals

(b) A pricing proposal must:

(5A) in the case of a NSW Distribution Network Service Provider – set out the amount paid, or required by an order under the Energy and Utilities Administration Act 1987 of New South Wales to be paid, by the provider to the Climate Change Fund in or in respect of the relevant regulatory year and reflect that amount in the expected revenue for the relevant regulatory year.

9.2 Climate Change Fund Requirement

The New South Wales Department of Environment and Climate Change has advised Integral Energy of the required 2009/10 contribution to the Climate Change Fund. Of the advised amount, no more than 25% can be recovered through residential tariffs.

The Climate Change Fund requirement has been provided to the AER on a confidential basis as Appendix C.

9.3 Climate Change Fund Recovery Tariff Setting Methodology

Climate Change Fund recovery tariffs have been in place since 1 July 2005 and are levied on the energy (kWh) based *charging parameter* of tariffs only. Existing tariffs are annually adjusted such that the weighted average price change for the climate change fund recovery portion of network price is evenly applied to all tariffs to achieve the required annual contribution amount (subject to the 25% cap placed by the Department on residential tariff contributions to the fund).

Integral Energy does not recover a contribution to the climate change fund from:

-
- controlled load tariffs as customers contribute to the fund through their primary tariff; or
 - inter-distributor transfer tariffs as customers contribute to the fund through the tariffs offered by the destination distributor.

Integral Energy's Climate Change Fund recovery tariffs have been provided to the AER on a confidential basis as Appendix C to this proposal.

Transmission cost recovery tariffs

10.1 Regulatory Requirement

10.1.1 Transitional Rule Requirements

In accordance with clause 6.18.7 of the *Transitional Rules*, and with respect to the recovery of charges for transmission use of system (TUOS) services, Integral Energy's *pricing proposal* must satisfy the following criteria:

6.18.7 Recovery of charges for transmission use of system services

- (a) A pricing proposal must provide for tariffs designed to pass on to customers the charges to be incurred by the Distribution Network Service Provider for transmission use of system services.*
- (b) The amount to be passed on to customers for a particular regulatory year must not exceed the estimated amount of the transmission use of system charges for the relevant regulatory year adjusted for over or under recovery in the previous regulatory year.*
- (c) The extent of the over or under recovery is the difference between:*
 - (1) the amount actually paid by the Distribution Network Service Provider by way of transmission use of system charges in the previous regulatory year; and*
 - (2) the amount passed on to customers by way of transmission use of system charges by the Distribution Network Service Provider in the previous regulatory year.*

10.1.2 2009 Distribution Determination Requirements

In its *2009 distribution determination*, the AER stated its requirements with respect to the reporting of TUOS under and over recoveries. The AER decided that, in accordance with clause 6.12.1(19) of the *Transitional Rules* Integral Energy must submit, as part of its *pricing proposal*, a record of the amount of revenues recovered from TUOS charges

and associated payments in accordance with Appendix I of the AER's 2009 *distribution determination*.

Integral Energy's approach to the recovery of TUOS costs has been developed to meet the requirements of the *Transitional Rules* and the AER's 2009 Determination. Integral Energy's approach to the setting of Transmission Cost Recovery Tariffs and the transmission use of system overs and unders account balance, developed in accordance with Appendix I of the AER's 2009 Determination, are discussed below.

10.2 Transmission cost recovery tariff methodology

The key principles of Integral Energy's Transmission Cost Recovery Tariff (TCR) Methodology are:

- Total TUOS allocated to network tariffs align with the total estimated transmission charge to be paid by Integral Energy¹⁹, adjusted for any overs and unders account balance;
- Transmission charges are allocated to network tariffs in a manner that reflects the cost drivers present in transmission pricing;
- Customers on an individually calculated tariff have transmission charges allocated in a manner that preserves the location and time signals of transmission pricing in accordance with the principles in Part J of chapter 6A of the *Rules*; and
- Network tariffs for smaller customer classes have transmission charges allocated on an energy basis, as location signals cannot be preserved.

10.3 Transmission use of system overs and unders account balance

The following extract from Appendix I of the 2009 Determination outlines Integral Energy's requirements with respect to the calculation of the transmission use of system overs and unders account balance:

Appendix I: Transmission use of system overs and unders account

To demonstrate compliance with clause 6.18.7 of the transitional chapter 6 rules and this final decision for the next regulatory control period, the AER requires the NSW DNSPs to maintain a transmission use of system (TUOS) overs and unders account. The NSW DNSPs must provide information on this account to the AER as part of their annual pricing proposals under clause 6.18.2(b)(7) of the transitional chapter 6 rules.

As part of their pricing proposals for each regulatory year of the next regulatory control period, the NSW DNSPs must provide the amounts for the following

¹⁹ Transmission charges for 2009-10 based on Transmission Price List applicable to Integral Energy as advised by TransGrid on 1 April 2009.

entries in their TUOS overs and unders account for the most recently completed regulatory year, the current regulatory year and the next regulatory year:

1. opening balance for each year
2. interest accrued on the opening balance for each year, calculated at the rate of the post-tax nominal rate of return as approved by the AER in its distribution determination, or the equivalent nominal rate of return approved by IPART for the 2004–09 regulatory control period
3. the amount representing the revenue recovered from TUOS charges applied in respect of that year, less the amounts of all transmission related payments made by the DNSP in respect of that year
4. an adjustment to the net amount in item 3 by six months of interest, accrued at the approved nominal rate of return
5. summation of the above amounts to derive the closing balance for each year.

The NSW DNSPs must provide details of calculations in the format set out in table I.1 of this final decision.

In accordance with Appendix I of the 2009 distribution determination, and consistent with the example TUOS calculation provided in Table I.1, the following table 10.1 provides the forecast 2009/10 balance of Integral Energy's transmission use of system overs and unders account.

Table 10.1 – Transmission overs and unders account balance (\$'000)

	2007/08	2008/09	2009/10
	Actual	Expected	Forecast
Revenue from TCR charges	94,738	119,431	161,174
Transmission Related Payments			
- Transmission charges to be paid to TNSP's	97,799	128,092	158,758
- Avoided TUOS payments	2,150	4,556	5,579
- One off refund paid to Integral by TransGrid	-	(3,818)	-
Total transmission related payments	99,950	128,830	164,337
Over / (Under) Recovery	(5,211)	(9,399)	(3,163)
Overs and Unders Account			
Annual Rate of Interest (applicable to balance)	9.70%	9.70%	8.83%
Semi Annual Rate of Interest	4.74%	4.74%	4.32%
Opening balance of trans overs/(unders) account	15,675	11,737	3,032
Interest on opening balance	1,520	1,139	268
Over / (under) recovery for financial year	(5,211)	(9,399)	(3,163)
Interest on over/under recovery	(247)	(445)	(137)
Closing Balance of Account	11,737	3,032	(0)

As illustrated in the above table, a one-off refund of \$3.8 million will be paid to Integral Energy by TransGrid in 2008/09. In May 2008, the AER approved a \$52.4 million 'pass through' adjustment to TransGrid's revenue cap in association with TransGrid's demand management and network support programs. TransGrid only expended \$38.1 million of the approved adjustment resulting in a \$14.3 million surplus in 2008/09, of which, \$3.8 million is payable to Integral Energy.

Integral Energy's transmission use of system cost recovery tariffs have been provided to the AER on a confidential basis as Appendix D to this proposal.

Customer Reassignment

11.1 Regulatory Requirement

In accordance with clause 6.18.4 of the *Transitional Rules*, Integral Energy is governed by the following customer reassignment principles:

6.18.4 Principles governing assignment or re-assignment of customers to tariff classes and assessment and review of basis of charging

(a) In formulating provisions of a distribution determination governing the assignment of customers to tariff classes or the re-assignment of customers from one tariff class to another, the AER must have regard to the following principles:

(1) customers should be assigned to tariff classes on the basis of one or more of the following factors:

(i) the nature and extent of their usage;

(ii) the nature of their connection to the network;

(iii) whether remotely-read interval metering or other similar metering technology has been installed at the customer's premises as a result of a regulatory obligation or requirement;

(2) customers with a similar connection and usage profile should be treated on an equal basis;

(3) however, customers with micro-generation facilities should be treated no less favourably than customers without such facilities but with a similar load profile;

(4) a Distribution Network Service Provider's decision to assign a customer to a particular tariff class, or to re-assign a customer from one tariff class to another should be subject to an effective system of assessment and review.

Note:

If (for example) a customer is assigned (or reassigned) to a tariff class on the basis of the customer's actual or assumed maximum demand, the system of assessment and review should allow for the reassignment of a customer who demonstrates a reduction or increase in maximum demand to a tariff class that is more appropriate to the customer's load profile.

(b) If the charging parameters for a particular tariff result in a basis of charge that varies according to the usage or load profile of the customer, a distribution determination must contain provisions for an effective system of assessment and review of the basis on which a customer is charged.

11.2 Proposed Compulsory Re-Assignment of Customers on 1 July 2009

Integral Energy intends to compulsorily assign 479 customers with annual consumption in excess of 160 MWh pa from the general supply IBT, general supply time of use and transitional time of use tariffs to the low voltage time of use demand and transitional network tariff on 1 July 2009.

The customers targeted for re-assignment meet the following criteria:

- Have an annual consumption in excess of 160MWh pa;
- Have time of use metering capable of supporting the proposed tariff;
- The expected network bill impact of the reassignment to the destination tariff is less than the bill impact the customer would have received had they stayed on their existing tariff.²⁰

This reform proposal is consistent with Integral's pricing policy of compulsory demand pricing for all customers with annual consumption greater than 160 MWh pa, which was introduced after significant public consultation on 1 July 2004.

A summary of the proposed compulsory re-assignment of customers is provided in the following table:

Table 11.1 – compulsory customer assignment

Origin Tariff	Proposed Tariff	Customers Assigned
General Supply IBT	Transitional Time of Use	27
	Low Voltage time of use Demand	133
General Supply Time of Use	Transitional Time of Use	121
	Low Voltage time of use Demand	60
Transitional Time of Use	Low Voltage time of use Demand	138
Total		479

²⁰ Bill impacts calculated on the basis of the 2007/08 annual consumption volume by customer.

Upon approval of the this pricing proposal, Integral Energy will satisfy the procedures for reassigning customers to tariff classes as determined by the AER in Appendix A of the *2009 distribution determination*.

Alternate Control Services – Public Lighting Tariffs

12.1 Determination

The AER's final decision on Public Lighting tariffs and charges (Section 17.11) as it applies to Integral Energy is as follows:

In accordance with clause 6.12.1(12) of the transitional chapter 6 rules, the control mechanism for Integral Energy's alternative control services is:

- *a schedule of fixed charges in the first year of the next regulatory control period for assets constructed before 1 July 2009 and a schedule of fixed prices in the first year of the next regulatory control period for assets constructed after 30 June 2009*
- *a price path for the remaining years of the next regulatory control period.*

The schedule of fixed charges applicable to Integral Energy for assets constructed before 1 July 2009 is contained in appendix P. The price path that has been applied to develop these charges is a straight-line smoothing which provides a fixed indexation rate for each year of the next regulatory control period.

The schedule of fixed prices for 2009–10 applicable to Integral Energy for assets constructed after 30 June 2009 is contained in appendix R. The prices will be adjusted annually by the December quarter CPI data as published by the ABS.

In response to the above decision Integral Energy proposes to apply the charges set out in Appendices P and R of the AER's 2009 *distribution determination*. These charges and their application are set out in the following sections and in the Appendices to this pricing proposal.

12.2 Prices for Public Lighting Assets Constructed Before 1 July 2009

The AER's compliance mechanism for public lighting requires Integral Energy to submit, *"as part of its pricing proposal, the total annual charge it proposes to levy on each of its public lighting customers over the next regulatory year"* for public lighting assets constructed before 1 July 2009.

Integral proposes to levy the charges set out in Appendix P of the AER's final decision and contained in Appendix F of this pricing proposal, subject to variations in inventory from the estimates applied by the AER in developing the fixed charges.

Integral Energy proposes to recover the charges by application of tariffs to actual inventories, consistent with historic billing methodologies and the method to be used for AER Public Lighting Tariffs 3 & 4. The tariffs will be determined such that, if there were no variations from the inventory used by the AER to model the total/aggregate charges, the tariffs would recover the charges set out in Appendix P of the *2009 distribution determination* and contained in Appendix F of this *pricing proposal* within a reasonable band of tolerance.

In the event that, due to changes in inventory, the nominated charges are over or under recovered, an adjustment will be applied to 2010/11 charges as part of the 2010 pricing submission, an approach consistent with the AER's *2009 distribution determination* (Section 17.9 – Compliance mechanism). It is also noted that underlying 2010/11 charges may be adjusted based on variations in 2010/11 opening inventory from that applied by the AER.

12.3 Prices for Public Lighting Assets Constructed After 30 June 2009

The 2009/10 prices proposed for public lighting assets constructed after 30 June 2009 are those contained in Appendix R of the AER's final decision, and repeated at Appendix G of this *pricing proposal*. These prices were considered as part of the *2009 distribution determination* and incorporate all factors including CPI. As such Integral Energy does not consider that any further adjustments are necessary for 2009/10.

Integral Energy proposes to apply these tariffs directly as inventories of the relevant components build up from 1 July 2009 onwards.

Integral Energy also notes the AER's comments in their final decision regarding recovery of tax liabilities on AER Tariff 4 assets, and notes that it is our intention to only apply the tax component where Integral takes ownership of the asset without having funded the capital cost. In cases where the customer funds the capital cost and ownership remains with the customer Integral Energy would not seek to recover the taxation component.

Glossary

Term	Definition
ABS	Australian Bureau of Statistics
AER	Australian Energy Regulator
Alternate Control Services	Per the Rules
Charging Parameters	Per the Rules
Connection	Per the Rules
Connection Services	Per the Rules
CEG	Competition Economists Group
CPI	Consumer Price Index
Current Regulatory Control Period	The regulatory period 1 July 2004 to 30 June 2009
Direct Control Services	Per the Rules
2009 Distribution Determination	New South Wales distribution determination 2009-10 to 2013-14 (AER, 28 April 2009)
Distribution Network Service Provider	Per the Rules
DUOS	Distribution Use of System
Distribution Use of System	Per the Rules
NUOS	Network Use of System
Pricing Proposal	Per the Rules
2009 Regulatory Control Period	The regulatory period 1 July 2009 to 30 June 2014
Regulatory Obligation or Requirement	Per the Rules
Regulatory Year	Per the Rules
Rules	National Electricity Rules
Standard Control Services	Per the Rules
Supply Point	The point of connection to Integral Energy's network
Tariff Class	Per the Rules
Transitional Rules	Clause 11.15 and Appendix 1 to Chapter 11 special transitional Chapter 6 arrangements for economic regulation of NSW distribution services for the <i>2009 regulatory control period</i>
WAPC	Weighted Average Price Cap